

THE BARNES–GINDIKIN SYMBOL AT FRACTIONAL RANK: CONTINUATION WITHOUT A DETERMINANT CARRIER, POSITIVITY WITHOUT A CONE

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Abstract

Fix $h > 0$. We use the Barnes double zeta to continue the cone-normalized N -factor Gindikin gamma product in its factor count, obtaining a meromorphic symbol $\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)$ on $\mathbb{C}^2$. At $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ it recovers the classical product exactly, and it satisfies rank addition and reflection, commuting rank and spectral shifts, and reciprocal-step covariance. Its spectral unit-shift quotient is rational exactly for $r \in \mathbb{Z}$ and polynomial exactly for $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$; consequently no polynomial Bernstein–Sato datum affine-compatible with this quotient exists away from the nonnegative integer lattice. We classify all entire multipliers preserving the cocycle and both unit shifts, determine their behaviour under reciprocal steps, and show that a sectorial large- s ratio normalization selects $\mathcal{G}_h$ uniquely.

Writing $d = 2h$, we then study a formal Jack–Riesz pairing with the same rank and step parameters. Each pivot is the product of one cell polynomial evaluated at $rd/2$ and at s , and its chamber interiors are fixed-rank slices of the Jack z -measure complementary series. At positive nonintegral rank the Wallach ray becomes bounded. When $d/2([r] - r)$ is integral we determine the exact finite-cutoff erosion staircase; for every rational $d/2$ we prove finite stabilization; and partition conjugation gives the duality

$$(r, d, s) \longmapsto \left(-\frac{rd}{2}, \frac{4}{d}, -\frac{2s}{d}\right).$$

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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 THE GINDIKIN PRODUCT USES RANK IN TWO DIFFERENT WAYS

Let Ω be an irreducible symmetric cone, the cone of squares of a Euclidean Jordan algebra of rank N and Peirce multiplicity d . Its Riesz–Gindikin integral evaluates to a product of N gamma factors whose arguments descend by the step $h := d/2$:

$$\Gamma_{\Omega}(s) = (2\pi)^{d\binom{N}{2}/2} \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} \Gamma(s - j\frac{d}{2}) = (2\pi)^{h\binom{N}{2}} \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} \Gamma(s - jh), \quad (1)$$

a formula of Gindikin, in the symmetric-cone form of Faraut and Korányi [6, 9].

The integer N occurs twice in (1), playing a different role each time. One is geometric: N is the rank of a Jordan algebra, an integer constrained by the classification. The other is combinatorial: N is the number of factors in a product. Every other quantity in (1) varies continuously; only the length of the product is pinned to an integer. Throughout Part I, N denotes a nonnegative integer factor count and r a complex factor count; in Part II, R denotes an integer cone rank and N the degree cutoff.

This paper continues the second. Fix $h > 0$ and let r be a complex variable in place of the factor count. We construct a function $\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)$, meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}^2$, agreeing with (1) at every $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, and determine which parts of its structure survive. Throughout, N denotes an integer rank and r a complex one; no Jordan algebra is claimed to exist at nonintegral r .

The problem is not continuation in s , which is classical — each fixed-length product is already meromorphic in s — nor continuation of a Gindikin–Koecher gamma in a tuple of spectral parameters, treated by Ding, Gross and Richards [5]. It is continuation in the length of the product, with the spacing h held fixed.

1.2 BARNES REGULARIZATION CONTINUES ONLY THE FACTOR COUNT

A product of gamma factors is the exponential of a sum of logarithms, and a sum whose length is to be made complex is what zeta regularization handles. Writing $\log \Gamma$ by the Lerch formula as a derivative of the Hurwitz zeta, the descending sum $\sum_{j=0}^{r-1} \log \Gamma(s - jh)$ becomes a difference of derivatives at $z = 0$ of the Barnes double zeta $\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h)$, and that difference continues in r without obstruction. Fixing the branch, the sign of the zeta derivative, and the power of 2π once and for all (Section 2) gives the symbol $\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)$, which we call the *Barnes–Gindikin symbol*.

The normalization is the one used for Shintani–Barnes gamma functions by Friedman and Ruijsenaars [7] and, over rational cones, by Tizzano and Winding [16, 18]. What is new is reading the result as a function of the factor count.

1.3 TERMINATION AND POSITIVITY TEST DIFFERENT REALIZABILITY QUESTIONS

Integer ranks are recovered exactly. Theorem 3.1 shows $\mathcal{G}_h(N, s) = (2\pi)^{h\binom{N}{2}} \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} \Gamma(s-jh)$ at every $N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, so (1) is recovered exactly. The identity is not a fit through sampled points but a consequence of a telescoping identity for the double zeta together with Lerch's theorem.

Interval splitting produces exact functional equations. Section 4 derives five. Splitting the regularized interval at an interior rank produces a rank-addition cocycle,

$$\mathcal{G}_h(r+q, s) = (2\pi)^{hrq} \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) \mathcal{G}_h(q, s-rh), \quad (2)$$

and the same normalization gives a reflection law $\mathcal{G}_h(-r, s) \mathcal{G}_h(r, s+rh) = (2\pi)^{hr^2}$ across $r = 0$. Both hold as identities in the continuous variables, as do the two unit shifts of Theorem 4.2 and the reciprocal-step identity of Theorem 4.3, which relates $\mathcal{G}_h$ to $\mathcal{G}_{1/h}$. These are the identities on which Sections 5–11 rest.

Termination detects integral rank. The unit-step quotient of $\mathcal{G}_h$ in s is the single gamma ratio $R_{r,h}(s) = h^r \Gamma(s/h+1)/\Gamma(s/h+1-r)$. Theorem 5.1 shows it is rational in s if and only if $r \in \mathbb{Z}$, polynomial if and only if $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, and reciprocal-polynomial at negative integers, while nonintegral r leaves two infinite arithmetic progressions of poles and zeros that never meet. Termination in s is a faithful detector of integrality of the rank.

Polynomial determinant carriers disappear off the lattice. For a Jordan determinant of rank N and multiplicity d the Bernstein–Sato polynomial is $b(s) = \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} (s+1+jd/2)$, of degree N [6, 10]. Proposition 6.1 converts termination into nonexistence: a Bernstein–Sato polynomial compatible with the shift law, in the precise affine sense of (28), forces the rank to be a nonnegative integer. Negative integral ranks are excluded along with the nonintegral ones. The symbol exists analytically at every complex rank; what fails off the nonnegative integer lattice, under the affine compatibility condition (28), is a polynomial determinant carrier reproducing the spectral shift quotient. Proposition 6.4 computes the b -function of the degenerate cubic norm of $J_3(\mathbb{S})$, the 3×3 Hermitian cubic space over the sextonions, and obtains the multiplicity-four value, so that carrier does not realize the formal step $d = 6$.

The remaining ambiguity is classified. Lemma 7.1 classifies entire additive cocycles: every one is a coboundary $\varphi(s) - \varphi(s-rh)$. Lemma 7.2 reduces an arbitrary entire multiplicative deformation to that additive setting, and Theorem 7.3 then determines every one of them: a rank character $e^{2\pi ikr}$ times a coboundary of a profile periodic under both shifts. For $h = p/q$ the profile ranges over the entire functions of period $1/q$; for irrational h it is constant, so only the characters remain, and a fixed logarithmic lift is rigid. Proposition 7.4 shows that reciprocal covariance couples the two character indices, and Proposition 7.5 computes the least nonzero type, $2\pi p$, carried by the fundamental periodic harmonics. Proposition 7.6 places $\mathcal{G}_h$ itself outside the order-one growth class to which Carlson-type theorems apply, and Corollary 7.8

closes uniqueness relative to an asymptotic normalization in s . We therefore claim canonicity relative to the stated axioms, not a unique continuation.

Positivity survives at fractional rank. Sections 8–11 study the associated formal Jack–Riesz pairing, every sign in which is controlled by a single lattice polynomial evaluated at two points. At positive nonintegral rank the unbounded Wallach ray disappears. The all-degree locus is bounded; at rational steps it contains a closed cell chamber around the balanced point, while the initial finite-cutoff band may subsequently erode or fragment.

The two halves test different questions. The Bernstein–Sato quotient shows that a compatible finite-dimensional polynomial determinant model can occur only at nonnegative integral rank. The formal Jack–Riesz pairing shows that positivity is weaker: at fractional rank it persists on explicit intervals and isolated points. Integrality is therefore detected by polynomial termination, not by positivity alone.

1.4 RELATION TO BARNES PRODUCTS, BERNSTEIN–SATO THEORY, AND JACK z -MEASURES

Zeta-regularized products, Barnes multiple gamma functions, cone-indexed multiple gamma functions, and their cocycle-type functional equations are all established [1, 7, 16, 18, 14]. To our knowledge, however, the continuation of the *number of Gindikin factors* away from the integer cone rank, with the Peirce step held fixed, has not appeared. The b -function normalization we use is the classical one of Faraut–Korányi together with the prehomogeneous classification of Kimura, cited precisely where used.

The positivity half of the paper runs directly into an existing literature. The cell products controlling the positivity analysis in Sections 8–11 are the weights of the Jack z -measures of Borodin and Olshanski [3], and two of the mechanisms used there — strict chamber positivity and the conjugation symmetry — are their results read on a fixed-rank slice. **Proposition 8.3** makes the identification precise and Section 8.2 isolates what does not follow from it: the closed semidefinite loci at fixed rank, the finite-degree erosion, the classification at integral defect, and the exact stabilization degree.

The argument proceeds in three stages. Sections 2–7 construct the symbol, recover the integer product, derive its functional equations, detect integrality through termination, exclude fractional polynomial determinant carriers, and fix the continuation by spectral normalization. Sections 8–10 turn positivity into a cell-lattice problem, describe the loss and erosion of the Wallach ray, and isolate the arithmetic regimes in which the surviving locus stabilizes. Section 11 transports these loci across reciprocal steps, and Section 12 explains why positivity persists after polynomial carriers disappear.

Part I. Analytic Continuation and Carrier Obstructions

2 BARNES REGULARIZATION MAKES THE FACTOR COUNT MEROMORPHIC

Everything downstream is stated relative to a single fixed choice of Barnes double zeta function, branch, and regularization. We fix it here and never vary it. The choice is the Shintani–Barnes convention of Friedman and Ruijsenaars [7], cross-checked against the rational-cone conventions of Tizzano–Winding [16]; nothing in the construction is left to an invisible normalization factor.

2.1 THE DOUBLE ZETA CONTINUES THE DESCENDING LOGARITHMIC SUM

Definition 2.1 (Barnes double zeta and its regularized log-gamma). Fix a step $h > 0$. For $\operatorname{Re}(a) > 0$, the Barnes double zeta with quasi-periods 1 and h is

$$\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h) = \sum_{m, n \geq 0} (a + m + nh)^{-z}, \quad \operatorname{Re}(z) > 2, \quad (3)$$

with the principal logarithm in every complex power. The sum continues meromorphically in z to all of $\mathbb{C}$ for each fixed a with $\operatorname{Re}(a) > 0$, and continues in a along paths avoiding the lattice $-(\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} + h\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0})$; for general complex z the powers have branch points there, so the continuation in a is single-valued on the cut plane, or on the universal cover of its complement, rather than meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}$. What becomes meromorphic after exponentiation is the symbol of Definition 2.2. The regularized logarithm of the double zeta is its z -derivative at the origin,

$$F_h(a) = \partial_z \zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h)|_{z=0}. \quad (4)$$

Its single-variable analogue is the Lerch evaluation of $\log \Gamma$. Writing $\zeta_H(z, a) = \sum_{m \geq 0} (a+m)^{-z}$ for the Hurwitz zeta, that evaluation reads

$$\partial_z \zeta_H(z, a)|_{z=0} = \log \Gamma(a) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi). \quad (5)$$

The double zeta (3) is built to make F_h the two-index analogue, and the regularized descending product is defined through it.

2.2 CONE NORMALIZATION PRODUCES A SINGLE-VALUED MEROMORPHIC SYMBOL

Definition 2.2 (The Barnes–Gindikin symbol). For a rank r and a spectral shift s , the regularized descending interval of log-gamma values is defined to be

$$\operatorname{Reg} \sum_{j=0}^{r-1} \log \Gamma(s - jh) := F_h(s + h - rh) - F_h(s + h) + \frac{r}{2} \log(2\pi). \quad (6)$$

The symbol itself is built from two ingredients, each single-valued. The *Barnes factor* is

$$B_h(a) = \exp F_h(a), \quad \operatorname{Re} a > 0, \quad (7)$$

with its standard meromorphic continuation in a , and the *cone exponent* is

$$A_h(r) = \frac{r}{2} + \frac{hr(r-1)}{2}. \quad (8)$$

The symbol is the corresponding power of 2π times the Barnes ratio:

$$\mathcal{G}_h(r, s) = (2\pi)^{A_h(r)} \frac{B_h(s + h - rh)}{B_h(s + h)} \quad (9)$$

Then $\mathcal{G}_h$ is meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}^2$; no branch data are attached to it, because none are needed. Its *logarithm* is the only multivalued object here, and on any simply connected open set that avoids the divisor it admits the lift

$$\log \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) = F_h(s + h - rh) - F_h(s + h) + A_h(r) \log(2\pi). \quad (10)$$

Every functional equation below is a global identity of meromorphic functions; its logarithmic version is read on a common local lift.

The two terms of A_h are kept separate and named: $r/2 \log(2\pi)$ is the Lerch constant of (5) summed along the interval, and $\frac{hr(r-1)}{2} \log(2\pi)$ is the cone prefactor matching the (2π) -power of the Gindikin product (1).

Remark 2.1. Reduction of a double zeta to a Barnes gamma can in general carry an additive polynomial in the logarithm [7, Prop. 3.2]; fixing all three components of (10) explicitly, rather than absorbing them into an overall constant, is what makes the cocycle and reflection laws below close exactly, with no residual constant left over.

3 INTEGER FACTOR COUNTS RECOVER THE GINDIKIN PRODUCT EXACTLY

The continuation has the following exact specialization, obtained directly from the difference equation of the double zeta together with the Lerch formula.

Theorem 3.1 — Integer specialization

For every nonnegative integer N ,

$$\mathcal{G}_h(N, s) = (2\pi)^{hN(N-1)/2} \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} \Gamma(s - jh). \quad (11)$$

In particular $\mathcal{G}_h$ reproduces the Gindikin product (1) on the nonnegative integers, with the empty product giving $\mathcal{G}_h(0, s) = 1$.

Proof of Theorem 3.1. The argument telescopes the double zeta and then applies the Lerch formula a single time.

Step 1 (*telescoping the double zeta*). Shifting the index $n \mapsto n + 1$ in (3) removes the row $n = 0$, so in the region of absolute convergence

$$\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h) - \zeta_2(z, a + h \mid 1, h) = \sum_{m \geq 0} (a + m)^{-z} = \zeta_H(z, a), \quad (12)$$

and both sides continue meromorphically in z , so (12) persists by analytic continuation. Iterating (12) N times gives

$$\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h) - \zeta_2(z, a + Nh \mid 1, h) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \zeta_H(z, a + kh). \quad (13)$$

Step 2 (*differentiating at zero*). Apply $\partial_z|_{z=0}$ to (13) and use the Lerch formula (5) on each of the N summands on the right:

$$F_h(a) - F_h(a + Nh) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \left(\log \Gamma(a + kh) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) \right). \quad (14)$$

Step 3 (*substitution and assembly*). Put $a = s + h - Nh$, so that $a + Nh = s + h$ and, as k runs from 0 to $N - 1$, the arguments $a + kh = s - (N - 1 - k)h$ run through the set $\{s - jh : 0 \leq j \leq N - 1\}$. Identity (14) then reads

$$F_h(s + h - Nh) - F_h(s + h) = \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \log \Gamma(s - jh) - \frac{N}{2} \log(2\pi).$$

Substituting this into the definition (10) at $r = N$, the $-N/2 \log(2\pi)$ cancels the Lerch term $+N/2 \log(2\pi)$ and leaves

$$\log \mathcal{G}_h(N, s) = \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \log \Gamma(s - jh) + \frac{hN(N-1)}{2} \log(2\pi),$$

which is (11) after exponentiation. The Lerch formula (5) is the only analytic input, and the telescoping (12)–(13) is exact; no step depends on the size of N . $\square$

Remark 3.1. The proof isolates where continuity in r comes from: the left-hand side of (14) is $F_h(s + h - rh) - F_h(s + h)$ with $r = N$, and that expression is already meromorphic in a *complex* r . Integer specialization is the statement that on the integers this analytic object coincides with the finite product; the content of the paper is what the same object does between the integers.

4 EXACT FUNCTIONAL EQUATIONS ARISE FROM CUTTING AND RESCALING THE REGULARIZED INTERVAL

The structural core of the construction is a family of functional equations. They are not asymptotic, and they are not inferred from matching the symbol at integer ranks: they are exact relations among the regularized intervals (10), holding as meromorphic identities in all complex variables. The mechanism is a single observation, rendered in Figure 1: a descending product of gamma factors can be cut at an interior point.

4.1 CUTTING THE INTERVAL GIVES THE RANK COCYCLE

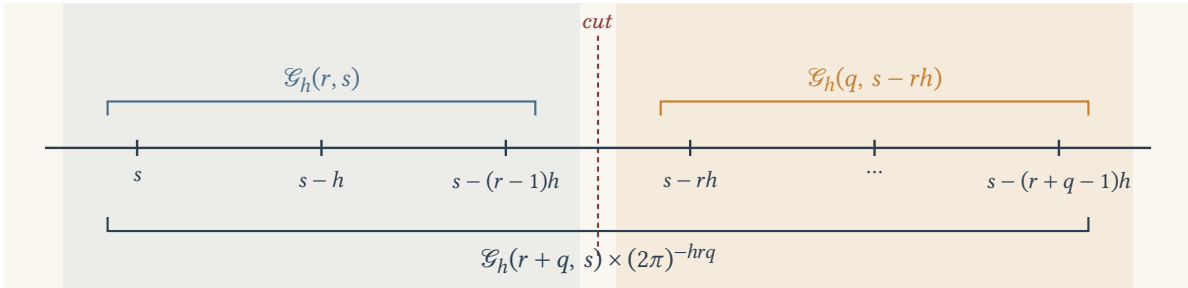
Theorem 4.1 — Interval splitting gives the rank cocycle

The Barnes–Gindikin symbol satisfies, for all $r, q, s \in \mathbb{C}$,

$$\mathcal{G}_h(r+q, s) = (2\pi)^{hrq} \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) \mathcal{G}_h(q, s-rh), \quad (15)$$

$$\mathcal{G}_h(-r, s) \mathcal{G}_h(r, s+rh) = (2\pi)^{hr^2}. \quad (16)$$

Both are global identities of meromorphic functions.



descending Γ -argument, step h

Figure 1. The cocycle is an interval split, the two shaded spans being the two factors. Drawn at integer r and q , where the picture is literal: the descending gamma arguments of $\mathcal{G}_h(r+q, s)$ break at the cut $s - rh$ into the r factors of $\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)$ and the q factors of $\mathcal{G}_h(q, s - rh)$. The shift $s \mapsto s - rh$ in the second symbol is exactly the position of the cut, and the mismatch in the (2π) -bookkeeping across it is the cross-term $(2\pi)^{hrq}$. At complex r, q there is no factor count to draw; what persists is (15), the meromorphic continuation of this identity.

Proof of Theorem 4.1. Write $B = B_h$. The Barnes ratio of (9) telescopes:

$$\frac{B(s+h-(r+q)h)}{B(s+h)} = \frac{B(s+h-rh)}{B(s+h)} \cdot \frac{B((s-rh)+h-qh)}{B((s-rh)+h)}, \quad (17)$$

the second quotient being exactly the one occurring in $\mathcal{G}_h(q, s - rh)$. For the prefactor, the cone exponent A_h of (8) obeys the addition rule

$$A_h(r + q) - A_h(r) - A_h(q) = hrq, \quad (18)$$

since the linear part of A_h is additive and $h/2[(r+q)^2 - (r+q) - r^2 + r - q^2 + q] = hrq$. Multiplying (17) by $(2\pi)^{A_h(r+q)}$ and inserting (18) gives (15).

For the reflection, put $q = -r$ in (15). Then $\mathcal{G}_h(0, s) = 1$ directly from (9), so

$$1 = (2\pi)^{-hr^2} \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) \mathcal{G}_h(-r, s - rh),$$

which is exactly the reflection law (16).

No logarithm was taken anywhere above, so no branch was chosen; the logarithmic forms of (15) and (16) hold on any common simply connected lift. $\square$

4.2 COMMUTING RANK AND SPECTRAL SHIFTS PRODUCES THE SHIFT QUOTIENT

Theorem 4.2 — Rank and spectral shifts commute

For all $r, s \in \mathbb{C}$, as meromorphic identities,

$$\frac{\mathcal{G}_h(r, s + 1)}{\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)} = R_{r,h}(s), \quad R_{r,h}(s) := h^r \frac{\Gamma(s/h + 1)}{\Gamma(s/h + 1 - r)}, \quad (19)$$

$$\frac{\mathcal{G}_h(r + 1, s)}{\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)} = (2\pi)^{hr} \Gamma(s - rh). \quad (20)$$

The two are compatible: $R_{r+1,h}(s)/R_{r,h}(s) = s - rh$.

Proof of Theorem 4.2. Deleting the row $m = 0$ from (3) and rescaling the remaining lattice by h gives the second difference equation of the double zeta,

$$\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h) - \zeta_2(z, a + 1 \mid 1, h) = \sum_{n \geq 0} (a + nh)^{-z} = h^{-z} \zeta_H(z, \frac{a}{h}). \quad (21)$$

Differentiating at $z = 0$ and using $\zeta_H(0, x) = 1/2 - x$ together with the Lerch formula (5),

$$F_h(a) - F_h(a + 1) = \log \Gamma\left(\frac{a}{h}\right) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) + \left(\frac{a}{h} - \frac{1}{2}\right) \log h. \quad (22)$$

Apply (22) at the two endpoints $a_1 = s + h - rh$ and $a_2 = s + h$ of (10). The prefactor $A(r) \log(2\pi)$ does not depend on s and cancels, the two Lerch constants cancel against each other, and the $\log h$ terms combine to $(a_2 - a_1)h^{-1} \log h = r \log h$. What remains is

$$\log \mathcal{G}_h(r, s + 1) - \log \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) = \log \frac{\Gamma(s/h + 1)}{\Gamma(s/h + 1 - r)} + r \log h,$$

which is (19). For (20), put $q = 1$ in the cocycle (15) and use $\mathcal{G}_h(1, x) = \Gamma(x)$ from Theorem 3.1. The compatibility relation follows from $\Gamma(x + 1) = x\Gamma(x)$ with $x = s/h - r$. $\square$

We call $R_{r,h}$ the *shift quotient*. It is not an auxiliary construction: by (19) it is the unit-step quotient of the symbol in the spectral variable, so any realization of $\mathcal{G}_h$ by a shift-invariant model must reproduce it. Sections 5 and 6 exploit exactly that. The compatibility relation is a discrete zero-curvature condition: the r -update and the s -update commute, which is the local counterpart of the cocycle.

A third functional equation relates the symbol at reciprocal steps. It is not a consequence of the cocycle, and it couples different values of h .

4.3 RESCALING THE BARNES LATTICE SENDS h TO $1/h$

Theorem 4.3 — Rescaling the Barnes lattice sends h to $1/h$

Write $Q_h(a) = \zeta_2(0, a \mid 1, h) = \frac{a^2}{2h} - \frac{(1+h)a}{2h} + \frac{h^2 + 3h + 1}{12h}$. Then

$$F_h(a) = F_{1/h}\left(\frac{a}{h}\right) - \log h \cdot Q_h(a), \quad (23)$$

and consequently

$$\mathcal{G}_h(r, s) = (2\pi)^{(1-h)r} h^{rs + \frac{r(h-1)}{2} - \frac{hr^2}{2}} \mathcal{G}_{1/h}\left(hr, \frac{s}{h} + 1 - \frac{1}{h}\right). \quad (24)$$

The powers of $h > 0$ use the real logarithm; the resulting formula is a meromorphic identity in r and s .

Proof of Theorem 4.3. Every lattice point of (3) factors as $a + m + nh = h(a/h + m/h + n)$, so $\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h) = h^{-z} \zeta_2(z, a/h \mid 1/h, 1)$, and ζ_2 is symmetric in its two quasi-periods. Evaluating at $z = 0$ gives $Q_h(a) = \zeta_2(0, a/h \mid 1, 1/h)$, and differentiating at $z = 0$ gives (23). Substituting (23) at the two endpoints of (10), matching $s/h + 1$ against the upper endpoint of the reciprocal symbol and $s/h + 1 - r$ against its lower endpoint, identifies the reciprocal rank as hr and the reciprocal shift as $s/h + 1 - 1/h$; collecting the residual Q_h difference and the prefactor exponents gives the elementary cofactor in (24). $\square$

Remark 4.1. Reciprocity couples the h and $1/h$ columns without removing the periodic ambiguity at either step. Writing $h = p/q$ in lowest terms, the fundamental profiles of Section 7 transform covariantly: at $u = s/h + 1 - 1/h$ one has $2\pi pu = 2\pi qs + 2\pi(p - q)$ with $p - q \in \mathbb{Z}$, so a profile of period $1/q$ at step h is carried to a profile of period $1/p$ at step $1/h$, and the associated deformations correspond under (24). The two periodic coboundary spaces are therefore in bijection. On the discrete part, however, reciprocity is a genuine constraint: it couples the two rank characters, and Proposition 7.4 computes the coupling.

5 POLYNOMIAL TERMINATION DETECTS NONNEGATIVE INTEGRAL RANK

The Barnes–Gindikin symbol remains nonrational in the spectral variable even at positive integral rank. Its spectral unit-shift quotient behaves differently: it is rational exactly at integral rank and polynomial exactly at nonnegative integral rank. This section isolates that termination phenomenon.

The object to examine is the shift quotient $R_{r,h}$ of (19), which Theorem 4.2 identifies as the unit-step quotient of $\mathcal{G}_h$ in s . It is the falling-factorial content of the Gindikin product: at a nonnegative integer $r = N$ the gamma ratio is the descending factorial $(s/h)(s/h - 1) \cdots (s/h - N + 1)$, and the prefactor h^N clears denominators to give $\prod_{j=0}^{N-1} (s - jh)$ — exactly the product of arguments carried by $\mathcal{G}_h(N, s)$ in (11), stripped of its gamma envelope. That is the piece a genuine determinant would have to reproduce, and Section 6 uses it in that role. Its virtue here is that its analytic type in s , rational or not, is a clean detector, and the dichotomy proved below comes from a competition between two lattices of poles and zeros, shown in Figure 2.

Theorem 5.1 — The shift quotient terminates exactly at integral rank

Fix $h > 0$. The shift quotient $R_{r,h}$ is a rational function of s if and only if $r \in \mathbb{Z}$, and a polynomial in s if and only if $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$. Explicitly, for $N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$,

$$R_{N,h}(s) = \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} (s - jh), \quad R_{-N,h}(s) = \frac{1}{\prod_{k=1}^N (s + kh)} \quad (N \geq 1), \quad (25)$$

so negative integers give the reciprocal-polynomial branch. For $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, $R_{r,h}$ is not rational in s : it has infinitely many poles and infinitely many zeros.

Proof of Theorem 5.1. The prefactor h^r is a nonzero constant in s and affects neither rationality nor the divisor, so we argue with the gamma ratio.

Step 1 (the integer branches). For $r = N \geq 0$, repeated application of $\Gamma(x + 1) = x\Gamma(x)$ gives $\Gamma(s/h + 1)/\Gamma(s/h + 1 - N) = \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} (s/h - j)$; multiplying by h^N then yields the left identity of (25), a polynomial of degree N , the empty product at $N = 0$ being 1. For $r = -N$ with $N \geq 1$, the recurrence in the other direction gives $\Gamma(s/h + 1)/\Gamma(s/h + 1 + N) = 1/\prod_{k=1}^N (s/h + k)$, and multiplying by h^{-N} yields the right identity, which is rational and reciprocal-polynomial but not a polynomial.

Step 2 (the converse, by divisor). Write $x = s/h$. The numerator $\Gamma(x + 1)$ contributes poles of $R_{r,h}$ at $x = -1, -2, -3, \dots$, i.e. at $s \in \{-h, -2h, -3h, \dots\}$. The reciprocal denominator $1/\Gamma(x + 1 - r)$ contributes zeros at $x + 1 - r = 0, -1, -2, \dots$, i.e. at $s \in \{h(r - 1), h(r - 2), h(r - 3), \dots\}$. These are two arithmetic progressions with common difference h : the poles lie on the coset $h\mathbb{Z}$, the zeros on the coset $h(r - 1) + h\mathbb{Z}$. The two cosets coincide exactly when $r - 1 \in \mathbb{Z}$, that is when $r \in \mathbb{Z}$; then the deep-negative tails of the two progressions agree term for term and cancel,

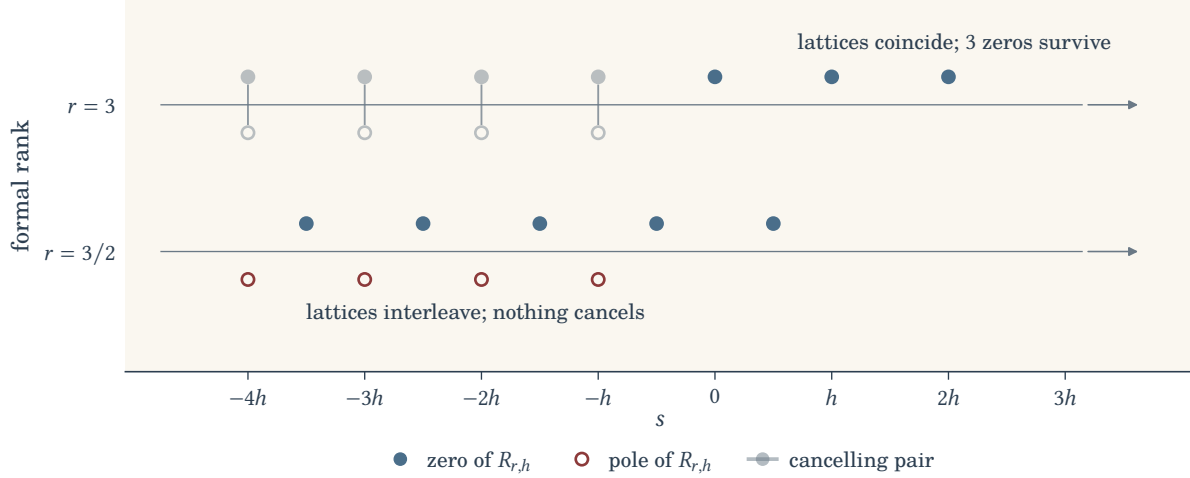


Figure 2. Termination is divisor cancellation. Zeros are drawn on the upper tier of each row and poles on the lower, so coincidence of the two lattices is vertical alignment and failure of coincidence is a visible stagger. The shift quotient $R_{r,h}$ carries a pole lattice, at $-h, -2h, \dots$ from the numerator, and a zero lattice, at $h(r-1), h(r-2), \dots$ from the reciprocal denominator. At integer r the two share the grid $h\mathbb{Z}$, the negative tails coincide and cancel, and finitely many zeros survive, so $R_{r,h}$ is a polynomial when $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and reciprocal-polynomial when r is a negative integer. At nonintegral r the zero lattice sits on a different coset of $h\mathbb{Z}$, the tails interleave without cancelling, and infinitely many poles and zeros remain.

leaving only finitely many uncanceled points — which Theorem 5.1’s integer branches identify. When $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$ the two cosets are disjoint, so no pole meets any zero; both progressions survive in full, and $R_{r,h}$ has infinitely many poles and zeros. A nonzero rational function on the Riemann sphere has only finitely many of each, so $R_{r,h}$ is not rational. This is a statement about the whole meromorphic function, not about a finite sample of values. $\square$

6 POLYNOMIAL BERNSTEIN QUOTIENTS EXCLUDE FRACTIONAL DETERMINANT CARRIERS

6.1 JORDAN DETERMINANTS REALIZE THE TERMINATED SHIFT QUOTIENT

The symbol $\mathcal{G}_h(r, s)$ exists, as an analytic object, at every complex rank, and so does its shift quotient. The termination theorem says that the shift quotient is rational only at integral rank and polynomial only at nonnegative integral rank. This section draws the structural consequence: a nonintegral rank cannot be the rank of a *determinant*, in a sense made precise through the theory of Bernstein–Sato b -functions. The result is a no-go theorem; its scope is fixed once, after Proposition 6.1.

For a simple Euclidean Jordan algebra of rank N and Peirce multiplicity d , the determinant Δ is a relative invariant of the structure group, and its Bernstein–Sato identity is classical [6, Prop. VII.1.4]: writing the identity with the standard exponent $s + 1$ on the input,

$$\Delta^*(\partial) \Delta^{s+1} = b(s) \Delta^s, \quad b(s) = \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} \left(s + 1 + j \frac{d}{2} \right). \quad (26)$$

The b -function is a polynomial of degree exactly N , its roots the arithmetic progression $-1, -1 - d/2, \dots, -1 - (N-1)d/2$. For the Albert algebra, where $(N, d) = (3, 8)$, this is $(s+1)(s+5)(s+9)$, the entry recorded in Kimura’s classification of the exceptional 27-dimensional determinant [10, Prop. 2.22, entry (27)]; the formal step $d = 6$ at rank 3 would give $(s+1)(s+4)(s+7)$. The step $d/2 = h$ of the b -function’s roots is the same step that governs the shift quotient’s divisor, and the coincidence is exact rather than approximate: comparing (26) with the integer specialization $R_{N,h}(u) = \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} (u - jh)$ of Theorem 5.1 at $u = -s - 1$ gives

$$b(s) = (-1)^N R_{N,h}(-s - 1) \quad (N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}). \quad (27)$$

The classical b -function is thus the shift quotient itself, read backwards through the affine substitution $u = -s - 1$. That identification is what makes the compatibility hypothesis of Proposition 6.1 a description of the classical situation rather than a condition invented to force the result.

6.2 POLYNOMIALITY FORCES NONNEGATIVE INTEGRAL RANK

The obstruction is best stated for the shift quotient alone, with no auxiliary notion of carrier. Any realization compatible with the shift law is then covered by a single corollary, and nothing is assumed that makes the conclusion automatic.

Proposition 6.1 — Polynomial Bernstein quotients force nonnegative integral rank

Fix $h > 0$ and $r \in \mathbb{C}$. Suppose there are a nonzero polynomial $b \in \mathbb{C}[u]$ and constants $a, c \in \mathbb{C}^\times, \beta \in \mathbb{C}$, with

$$b(u) = c R_{r,h}(au + \beta) \quad (28)$$

as meromorphic functions of u . Then $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and $\deg b = N$.

Proof of Proposition 6.1. A nondegenerate affine substitution $u \mapsto au + \beta$ with $a \neq 0$, followed by multiplication by $c \neq 0$, is invertible on meromorphic functions and preserves both polynomiality and degree. Hence (28) holds with b polynomial exactly when $R_{r,h}$ is polynomial, and then $\deg b = \deg R_{r,h}$. By Theorem 5.1 that happens precisely for $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, in which case the degree is N . $\square$

Corollary 6.2. Let f be a polynomial determinant, or more generally a relative invariant of a prehomogeneous vector space, whose Bernstein–Sato polynomial b_f is compatible with the Barnes–Gindikin shift quotient in the sense of (28) for some r . Then r must be a nonnegative

integer, and $\deg b_f = r$. Jordan determinants and prehomogeneous relative invariants are the principal examples, but no such structure is required of f .

The classical Jordan determinant satisfies (28) exactly: by (27) the classical Jordan determinant of a rank- N simple Euclidean Jordan algebra saturates (28) exactly, with $a = -1$, $\beta = -1$ and $c = (-1)^N$. What Proposition 6.1 adds is that no other value of r can do so. Both directions of the integer condition are used: nonintegral r is excluded by the infinitude of the divisor, and negative integral r is excluded because the quotient inverts to a product of linear forms.

The scope of the obstruction, stated once. It concerns polynomial Bernstein–Sato data affine-compatible with the shift quotient, and it constrains the *formal* rank appearing in the shift law rather than any dimension or rank of an underlying algebra. It does not exclude operator-algebraic, quotient, GNS, or nonpolynomial realizations; indeed Section 8 exhibits a genuine positive-semidefinite form at fractional rank, which some construction of that kind may well organize.

Remark 6.1 (Why the sextonionic cubic requires a separate computation). The obstruction above routes through termination and the classical prehomogeneous b -function, both established results. It does *not* include a from-scratch Bernstein–Sato computation for a degenerate cubic. The sextonionic Hermitian space $J_3(\mathbb{S})$ is the natural test: a 21-dimensional carrier of structural rank 3 whose cubic norm is degenerate. The radical of its polarized cubic is the six-dimensional ideal $A_3(\mathbb{H}^\perp)$; equivalently, the cubic factors through the fifteen-dimensional semisimple quotient. That carrier distinguishes structural rank from formal multiplicity, and for it the b -function can be computed outright. The computation is next, in two steps: first a general lemma about irrelevant variables, then its application to $J_3(\mathbb{S})$.

6.3 THE SEXTONIONIC CUBIC FACTORS THROUGH THE QUATERNIONIC QUOTIENT

Lemma 6.3 — Adjoining irrelevant variables does not change the b -function

Let $g \in \mathbb{C}[x_1, \dots, x_m] \setminus \{0\}$, and regard it as the element $f(x, y) = g(x)$ of the larger ring $\mathbb{C}[x_1, \dots, x_m, y_1, \dots, y_n]$. Then $b_f = b_g$.

Proof of Lemma 6.3. Let $B_g, B_f \subset \mathbb{C}[\sigma]$ be the two Bernstein ideals; for the general theory of Bernstein ideals and b -functions see [2, Ch. 1].

If $P(x, \partial_x, \sigma)g^{\sigma+1} = b(\sigma)g^\sigma$, the same operator, acting trivially in the y variables, gives $P(x, \partial_x, \sigma)f^{\sigma+1} = b(\sigma)f^\sigma$, so $B_g \subseteq B_f$.

Conversely let $Q(x, y, \partial_x, \partial_y, \sigma)f^{\sigma+1} = b(\sigma)f^\sigma$. Write Q in *normal order*, every ∂_y placed to the right of every coefficient:

$$Q = \sum_Y Q_Y(x, y, \partial_x, \sigma) \partial_Y^Y.$$

Every element of the Weyl algebra admits such a form, and the reordering is where the argument is actually made: $\partial_y y = y \partial_y + 1$, so a term written with ∂_y on the left does not differentiate in y last. Once Q is normally ordered, each $\gamma \neq 0$ annihilates $f^{\sigma+1}$, because f does not depend on y . Hence $Q_0(x, y, \partial_x, \sigma)g^{\sigma+1} = b(\sigma)g^\sigma$, and evaluating the polynomial coefficients at any fixed $y = y_0$ gives a Bernstein identity for g , so $b \in B_g$. The two Bernstein ideals therefore coincide, and so do their monic generators. $\square$

Proposition 6.4 — The sextonionic cubic has the quaternionic b-function

Work over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\mathbb{S}$ be the sextonion algebra, let

$$\pi: J_3(\mathbb{S}) \longrightarrow J_3(\mathbb{H})$$

be the quotient by its six-dimensional square-zero radical $A_3(\mathbb{H}^\perp)$ [17, Def. 3.1], [11, §8.2], and let f and g be the corresponding determinantal cubics. Then $f = g \circ \pi$ up to a nonzero scalar, and consequently

$$b_f(\sigma) = b_g(\sigma) = (\sigma+1)(\sigma+3)(\sigma+5) = \prod_{j=0}^2 \left(\sigma + 1 + j\frac{4}{2} \right). \quad (29)$$

The sextonionic cubic therefore carries the multiplicity-four Bernstein progression and does not realize the formal multiplicity $d = 6$, for which (26) would give $(\sigma+1)(\sigma+4)(\sigma+7)$.

Proof of Proposition 6.4. Write $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{H} \oplus N$ with $N = \mathbb{H}^\perp$ the two-dimensional Cayley module, $N \cdot N = 0$, norm $n(q + \eta) = n(q)$ and conjugation $\overline{q + \eta} = \bar{q} - \eta$ [17, Def. 3.1]. Then N is the radical of the polar form and the trace $t(x) = x + \bar{x}$ kills N .

Write $a_i = q_i + \eta_i$ for the three off-diagonal entries. In the cubic norm

$$f = x_1 x_2 x_3 - \sum_i x_i n(a_i) + t((a_1 a_2) a_3)$$

the norm term is unchanged by $a_i \mapsto a_i + \eta_i$ because N is totally isotropic and orthogonal to $\mathbb{H}$ for the polar form. For the trace term, N is an ideal with $N \cdot N = 0$, so a product of three elements at least one of which lies in N again lies in N ; every element of N has zero trace, so $t((a_1 a_2) a_3)$ is unchanged as well. Hence f is constant along the six directions spanned by the η_i , which is exactly $A_3(\mathbb{H}^\perp) = \ker \pi$, and $f = g \circ \pi$ with g the cubic norm of $J_3(\mathbb{H})$.

In coordinates adapted to the splitting, the six radical directions do not occur in f at all. Lemma 6.3 therefore gives $b_f = b_g$, a nonzero scalar being irrelevant to a monic Bernstein–Sato polynomial. Finally $J_3(\mathbb{H})$ is simple Euclidean of rank 3 and Peirce multiplicity $d = 4$, so (26) evaluates b_g as the right-hand side of (29). $\square$

The carrier therefore distinguishes structural rank from formal multiplicity without producing a new multiplicity: it has structural rank 3, its cubic is genuinely degenerate, and its b -function is nonetheless the one belonging to $d = 4$. The formal step $d = 6$ at rank 3 is not realized here, and by Proposition 6.1 it could only be realized by an object whose shift quotient is a polynomial of degree 3, which pins the rank but not the multiplicity.

7 SPECTRAL NORMALIZATION SELECTS A SYMBOL FROM THE FULL AMBIGUITY CLASS

The functional equations do not determine the continuation without an additional normalization. We first classify their holomorphic logarithmic deformations, then impose the two unit shifts and the integer-rank data. This isolates the periodic ambiguity at rational h , its disappearance at irrational h for a fixed logarithmic lift, and the function-level characters that remain. We then analyse growth and prove uniqueness under a spectral ratio normalization.

7.1 INTEGER VALUES ALONE DO NOT DETERMINE THE CONTINUATION

Agreement on integer ranks alone gives no useful uniqueness: additive tails such as $\mathcal{G}_h(r, s) + \sin(2\pi r)$ vanish on the lattice and are unconstrained off it. Since the cocycle (15) is multiplicative, a deformation with any chance of preserving it must act multiplicatively as well,

$$\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h(r, s) = \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) \exp(E(r, s)), \quad (30)$$

and it is the exponent E , not an additive tail, that must satisfy the additive form (31) of the cocycle. Asked in this form, the question has a complete answer.

7.2 EVERY ENTIRE DEFORMATION IS A CHARACTER TIMES A PERIODIC COBOUNDARY

Before exhibiting deformations we record that the coboundary form is not a choice: it is forced.

Lemma 7.1 (Classification of additive cocycles). Let $E : \mathbb{C}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be entire and satisfy

$$E(r + q, s) = E(r, s) + E(q, s - rh), \quad E(0, s) = 0. \quad (31)$$

for all $r, q, s \in \mathbb{C}$. Then $E(r, s) = \varphi(s) - \varphi(s - rh)$ for an entire φ , unique up to an additive constant.

Proof of Lemma 7.1. Differentiate (31) in q at $q = 0$ and set $a(s) = \partial_r E(0, s)$; the left side gives $\partial_r E(r, s)$ and the right gives $a(s - rh)$, so $\partial_r E(r, s) = a(s - rh)$. Since a is entire and $\mathbb{C}$ is simply connected, there is an entire φ with $\varphi' = a/h$. Then $\partial_r [\varphi(s) - \varphi(s - rh)] = h\varphi'(s - rh) = a(s - rh)$, and both $E(r, s)$ and $\varphi(s) - \varphi(s - rh)$ vanish at $r = 0$. Two entire functions of r with the same derivative and the same value at $r = 0$ coincide. For uniqueness, if φ_1 and φ_2 give the same cocycle then $\psi = \varphi_1 - \varphi_2$ satisfies $\psi(s) = \psi(s - rh)$ for all r, s ; as rh ranges over $\mathbb{C}$, ψ is invariant under every translation and hence constant. $\square$

The classification is stated for an additive exponent, and the reduction of an arbitrary entire multiplicative factor to that form is not an assumption but a consequence of the cocycle.

Lemma 7.2 (Every entire multiplicative cocycle has an entire logarithm). Let $h > 0$ and let $H \in \mathcal{O}(\mathbb{C}^2)$ satisfy

$$H(r + q, s) = H(r, s) H(q, s - rh), \quad H(0, s) = 1. \quad (32)$$

Then $H = e^E$ for an entire E satisfying the additive cocycle (31).

Proof of Lemma 7.2. Taking $q = -r$ in (32) gives $H(r, s)H(-r, s - rh) = H(0, s) = 1$, so H vanishes nowhere on $\mathbb{C}^2$. Then dH/H is a closed holomorphic 1-form on the simply connected $\mathbb{C}^2$, hence has a primitive: $H = e^{E_0}$ with E_0 entire. Since $e^{E_0(0, s)} = H(0, s) = 1$, the function $E_0(0, \cdot)$ takes values in $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$ and is continuous, hence equal to a single constant $2\pi i n$; put $E = E_0 - 2\pi i n$, so that $H = e^E$ and $E(0, s) = 0$. The cocycle defect

$$\delta(r, q, s) = E(r + q, s) - E(r, s) - E(q, s - rh)$$

is entire on $\mathbb{C}^3$ and satisfies $e^\delta = 1$ by (32), so it takes values in the discrete set $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$ and is therefore constant. At $q = 0$ it equals $-E(0, s - rh) = 0$, so $\delta \equiv 0$ and E satisfies (31). $\square$

Theorem 7.3 — Complete fixed-step entire ambiguity

Let $h > 0$. By Lemma 7.2 every entire multiplicative deformation of $\mathcal{G}_h$ preserving the rank-addition cocycle (15) is e^E for an entire E satisfying (31); let E be such a function and set $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h(r, s) = \mathcal{G}_h(r, s)e^{E(r, s)}$. Suppose $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h$ satisfies the same two exponentiated unit-shift equations as $\mathcal{G}_h$. Then there are an integer k and an entire ψ with

$$\psi(s + 1) = \psi(s), \quad \psi(s + h) = \psi(s), \quad (33)$$

such that

$$E(r, s) = 2\pi i k r + \psi(s) - \psi(s - rh). \quad (34)$$

Conversely, every E of this form preserves the rank-addition cocycle (15), the reflection (16), both exponentiated unit-shift equations, and every value $\mathcal{G}_h(N, s)$ with $N \in \mathbb{Z}$.

If the unit shifts are imposed as exact identities of a fixed logarithmic lift, then $k = 0$. If $h = p/q$ in lowest terms, the admissible ψ are exactly the entire functions of period $1/q$, modulo constants. If $h \notin \mathbb{Q}$, then ψ is constant, so the only function-level deformations are the rank characters $e^{2\pi i k r}$, and the fixed logarithmic lift is rigid.

Proof of Theorem 7.3. Lemma 7.1 gives an entire φ , unique modulo an additive constant, with $E(r, s) = \varphi(s) - \varphi(s - rh)$; the constant cancels from the difference.

Step 1 (the s -shift). Write $\Delta_1\varphi(s) = \varphi(s + 1) - \varphi(s)$. Preserving the exponentiated s -shift equation of Theorem 4.2 amounts to the requirement that

$$\exp(\Delta_1\varphi(s) - \Delta_1\varphi(s - rh)) = 1 \quad \text{for all } r, s \in \mathbb{C}.$$

The exponent is entire in (r, s) and takes values in the discrete set $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$, so it is constant; it vanishes at $r = 0$, hence vanishes identically. As rh ranges over all of $\mathbb{C}$, this says that the difference $\Delta_1\varphi$ is constant:

$$\varphi(s + 1) - \varphi(s) = c, \quad c \in \mathbb{C}. \quad (35)$$

Step 2 (the r -shift). Preserving the exponentiated r -shift equation means $\exp(\varphi(z) - \varphi(z - h)) = 1$ for all $z \in \mathbb{C}$, by the same computation applied to $z = s - rh$. The entire function $\varphi(z) - \varphi(z - h)$ therefore has image in $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$ and is constant:

$$\varphi(z + h) - \varphi(z) = 2\pi i k, \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}. \quad (36)$$

Step 3 (*splitting off the character*). Put $\psi(z) = \varphi(z) - \frac{2\pi ik}{h}z$. By (36) ψ has period h , so its restriction to $\mathbb{R}$ is bounded, h being positive and real. By (35), $\psi(z+1) - \psi(z) = c - \frac{2\pi ik}{h}$ is constant, and iterating the unit increment n times gives $\psi(x+n) - \psi(x) = n(c - \frac{2\pi ik}{h})$, which is unbounded in n unless the constant vanishes. Hence ψ has period 1 as well, and

$$E(r, s) = \varphi(s) - \varphi(s - rh) = \frac{2\pi ik}{h}(s - (s - rh)) + \psi(s) - \psi(s - rh) = 2\pi ikr + \psi(s) - \psi(s - rh),$$

which is the asserted form (34).

Step 4 (*the converse and the three specializations*). For the converse, $2\pi ikr$ is a coboundary for the linear profile $\varphi(s) = 2\pi iks/h$ and $\psi(s) - \psi(s - rh)$ is one for ψ , so both are additive cocycles and Lemma 7.1 applies in reverse; the cocycle and reflection identities hold for any coboundary, and (33) gives back both unit shifts after exponentiation. At $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}$ the character contributes $e^{2\pi i k N} = 1$ and the periodic part contributes $\psi(s) - \psi(s - Nh) = 0$, so $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h$ agrees with $\mathcal{G}_h$ at every integer rank.

If the unit shifts are imposed on a fixed lift, the lifted increment $E(r+1, s) - E(r, s) = 2\pi ik + \psi(s - rh) - \psi(s - rh - h) = 2\pi ik$ must vanish, so $k = 0$. If $h = p/q$ with $\gcd(p, q) = 1$, the group generated by 1 and h is $q^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, and (33) says exactly that ψ has period $1/q$; conversely every entire $1/q$ -periodic ψ has both periods. If h is irrational, $\mathbb{Z} + h\mathbb{Z}$ is dense in $\mathbb{R}$, so the entire ψ is constant on a dense subset of $\mathbb{R}$ modulo translation, hence constant, and only the rank characters survive. $\square$

Theorem 7.3 settles in one statement the two questions that the algebraic package leaves open, and it separates them cleanly. The rank character $e^{2\pi ikr}$ is invisible to every exponentiated identity and to every integer-rank value, and it is killed only by requiring the unit shifts of a fixed logarithmic lift; it is not killed by fixing the lift at $r = 0$, since $2\pi ikr$ also vanishes there. The periodic coboundary is the genuinely arithmetic part: at $h = p/q$ it is a full function space, at irrational h it is nothing at all. Every geometric Peirce step $h = d/2$ is rational, so the geometric cases are exactly the ones carrying the ambiguity.

The two recurrences in (33) impose invariance under the subgroup $\mathbb{Z} + h\mathbb{Z}$. Neither period condition can be discarded uniformly in h , although one may imply the other when one period is an integral multiple of the other: at $h = 1/2$, h -periodicity implies unit periodicity, whereas unit periodicity need not imply h -periodicity. A profile of period 1 but not of period $1/2$ preserves the s -recurrence while failing the r -recurrence and the integer-rank values. This is why the family survives all four algebraic constraints at once, and it is what distinguishes it from the additive witnesses above. For $h = p/q$ the profiles

$$\psi(s) = \varepsilon \sin(2\pi qs), \quad \psi(s) = \varepsilon \cos(2\pi qs) \tag{37}$$

are nonconstant of period exactly $1/q$, so the deformation is genuinely nontrivial off the lattice: with $\varepsilon = 1$ the exponent attains $E = 2$, its extremal value on the real locus, since the two sine terms in (34) can take opposite signs. As an entire function of two complex variables it has no global extremum.

7.3 RECIPROCAL COVARIANCE COUPLES THE REMAINING CHARACTER INDICES

The reciprocal-step identity of Theorem 4.3 is not consumed by the classification just proved: it acts on the classified family. On the periodic part it acts covariantly, carrying profiles to profiles, as Remark 4.1 records. On the discrete part it is a genuine constraint, and the constraint is arithmetic.

Proposition 7.4 — Reciprocal covariance couples the character indices

Let $h > 0$ and let $H_h(r, s) = e^{2\pi i k_h r}$, $H_{1/h}(r', s') = e^{2\pi i k_{1/h} r'}$ be rank characters at the two steps, with $k_h, k_{1/h} \in \mathbb{Z}$. The deformed pair $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h = \mathcal{G}_h H_h$ and $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_{1/h} = \mathcal{G}_{1/h} H_{1/h}$ satisfies (24) with the same elementary cofactor if and only if

$$H_h(r, s) = H_{1/h}\left(hr, \frac{s}{h} + 1 - \frac{1}{h}\right), \quad (38)$$

that is, if and only if

$$k_h = h k_{1/h}. \quad (39)$$

Consequently, if $h = p/q$ in lowest terms then

$$(k_h, k_{1/h}) = (pm, qm), \quad m \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad (40)$$

so the admissible index pairs form the rank-one lattice $\mathbb{Z} \cdot (p, q)$ inside $\mathbb{Z}^2$; and if $h \notin \mathbb{Q}$ then $k_h = k_{1/h} = 0$.

Proof of Proposition 7.4. Dividing the deformed instance of (24) by the undeformed one cancels the cofactor and the two symbols and leaves exactly (38). Evaluated on the two characters it reads $e^{2\pi i k_h r} = e^{2\pi i k_{1/h} hr}$ for all $r \in \mathbb{C}$; the difference of the two entire exponents takes values in $2\pi i \mathbb{Z}$, hence is constant, and it vanishes at $r = 0$, so $k_h = h k_{1/h}$. For $h = p/q$ with $\gcd(p, q) = 1$, (39) reads $qk_h = pk_{1/h}$, so $p \mid k_h$; writing $k_h = pm$ gives $k_{1/h} = qm$, and every such pair satisfies (39). If h is irrational then $k_h = h k_{1/h}$ with both indices integral forces $k_{1/h} = 0$, hence $k_h = 0$. $\square$

So reciprocity does constrain the classified family, though only through its discrete part. The periodic coboundary spaces at the two steps remain in bijection, exactly as Remark 4.1 says; what the reciprocal step pins down is the pair of rank characters, to a rank-one lattice at rational step and to nothing at all at irrational step. That is the function-level counterpart of the rigidity already recorded in Theorem 7.3.

7.4 FUNDAMENTAL COBOUNDARIES REVEAL THE FINER ZERO LATTICE

Because the family is explicit, its growth can be computed rather than estimated, and this is what converts the obstruction from a qualitative remark into a quantitative one.

Proposition 7.5 — Fundamental coboundaries vanish on a finer rank lattice

Let $h = p/q$ in lowest terms, take the profiles (37) with $\varepsilon = 1$, and write E_φ for either of the two resulting logarithmic deformations $E_{\cos}$ and $E_{\sin}$. Then for all complex r, s ,

$$\begin{aligned} E_{\cos}(r, s) &= -2 \sin(\pi q r h) \sin(\pi q(2s - rh)), \\ E_{\sin}(r, s) &= 2 \sin(\pi q r h) \cos(\pi q(2s - rh)), \end{aligned} \quad (41)$$

so the two profiles share the common envelope $\sin(\pi q r h)$, and they satisfy the s -free identity

$$E_{\cos}(r, s)^2 + E_{\sin}(r, s)^2 = 4 \sin^2(\pi q r h). \quad (42)$$

Consequently:

- (i) $E_\varphi(r, s) = 0$ for every s exactly when $r \in 1/p\mathbb{Z}$; this is the common envelope zero set of the two-profile family, and an individual profile carries further s -dependent phase zeros;
- (ii) along the ray $r = Re^{i\theta}$,

$$\limsup_{R \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{R} \log |E_\varphi(Re^{i\theta}, s)| = 2\pi q h |\sin \theta| = 2\pi p |\sin \theta|, \quad (43)$$

the ordinary limit existing whenever $\sin \theta \neq 0$ and failing on both real rays $\theta = 0$ and $\theta = \pi$, where E_φ is a bounded function of R with infinitely many zeros. Thus each of the two fundamental logarithmic deformations $E_{\cos}$ and $E_{\sin}$ has exponential type $2\pi p$ in the interpolation variable, depending only on the *numerator* of h . More generally, the n -th Fourier mode has type $2\pi|n|p$, while an arbitrary periodic entire profile need not have finite exponential type.

Proof of Proposition 7.5. The identities (41) are the sum-to-product formulas

$$\cos A - \cos B = -2 \sin \frac{A+B}{2} \sin \frac{A-B}{2}, \quad \sin A - \sin B = 2 \cos \frac{A+B}{2} \sin \frac{A-B}{2},$$

applied with $A = 2\pi q s$ and $B = 2\pi q(s - rh)$, so that $\frac{A+B}{2} = \pi q(2s - rh)$ and $\frac{A-B}{2} = \pi q r h$; and (42) follows because $\sin^2 + \cos^2 = 1$ identically. For (i), the second factor of (41) depends on s and the first does not, so vanishing for every s forces $\sin(\pi q r h) = 0$, that is $q r h = r p \in \mathbb{Z}$. For (ii), put $w = 2s - rh$, so that $\operatorname{Im} w = 2 \operatorname{Im} s - hR \sin \theta$ while $\operatorname{Im}(rh) = hR \sin \theta$. As $|\operatorname{Im} \cdot| \rightarrow \infty$ both $|\sin|$ and $|\cos|$ grow like $1/2e^{\pi q |\operatorname{Im} \cdot|}$, so each factor contributes $\pi q h R |\sin \theta| + O(1)$ and the product contributes $2\pi q h R |\sin \theta| + O(1)$, with $2\pi q h = 2\pi p$. On either real ray, $\theta = 0$ or $\theta = \pi$, both imaginary parts remain bounded, so $|E_\varphi|$ is a bounded function of R ; by (i) it vanishes whenever $R \in 1/p\mathbb{Z}$, while it is not identically zero, so its modulus is also bounded away from zero along some sequence. The lim sup is therefore 0 and no ordinary limit exists. $\square$

Part (i) sharpens what agreement at integer ranks is worth: the periodic-coboundary subfamily of Theorem 7.3 agrees with $\mathcal{G}_h$ not merely on $\mathbb{Z}$ but on the lattice $1/p\mathbb{Z}$, which is p times finer. The rank characters do not, since $e^{2\pi ikr}$ is generally nontrivial there. Integer agreement is a considerably weaker constraint than it appears, and this is the precise sense in which the additive witnesses of the previous subsection are inadequate: they are valid against interpolation constrained only on the integer lattice, and insufficient against the full cocycle-compatible package.

Second, $2\pi p$ is the type of the *fundamental* harmonic, not of the ambiguity space. The admissible profiles form the space of functions of period $1/q$; its n -th Fourier mode $\varphi_n(s) = e^{2\pi i n q s}$ has envelope $\sin(\pi n q r h)$ and hence type $2\pi|n|p$, and a general periodic entire profile need not have finite exponential type at all. Thus $2\pi p$ is the least type occurring among the nonzero Fourier modes, and any statement below about “the type of the ambiguity” should be read in that sense. It is in any case an assertion about the *logarithmic* deformation E_φ and about nothing else. It does not describe $\exp(E_\varphi)$, which is the multiplicative ambiguity actually acting on $\mathcal{G}_h$ and which has infinite entire order; nor does it describe $\mathcal{G}_h$, whose growth is computed in Proposition 7.6 below and is of a different class altogether. Keeping the three objects apart is essential to the discussion that follows.

For integer h one has $p = h$, so that $2\pi p = \pi d$ with $d = 2h$. This is a restricted arithmetic identity, holding exactly when the reduced denominator q equals 1; in general the type is $2\pi p = \pi q d$. We record it because d also indexes the positivity analysis of Sections 8–11, but no causal or independently measured link between the two is claimed, and the identity fails already at $h = 1/2$, where $d = 1$ and $2\pi p = 2\pi \neq \pi$. Among simple Euclidean Jordan algebras of rank at least 3, the Peirce multiplicities are $d \in \{1, 2, 4\}$, together with the exceptional value $d = 8$ only at rank 3. Rank-2 spin factors realize every integer multiplicity $d \geq 1$. Thus the pair $(r, d) = (3, 6)$ used here is formal, although $d = 6$ does occur for genuine rank-2 spin factors.

Remark 7.1 (The rate near the real axis). The angular law (43) degrades as $\theta \rightarrow 0$, and the factorization (41) locates the transition exactly. For $b = \operatorname{Im} s > 0$, $\sin \theta > 0$ and $r = R e^{i\theta}$ the exponential envelope is

$$\log |E_\varphi| = \pi q (hR \sin \theta + |2b - hR \sin \theta|) + O(1), \quad (44)$$

whose leading radial slope is 0 for $R < R_2$ and equals $2\pi q h \sin \theta$ for $R > R_2$, where

$$R_2 = \frac{2 \operatorname{Im}(s)}{h \sin \theta}.$$

The locus $\operatorname{Im}(s - rh) = 0$, at $R_1 = \operatorname{Im}(s)/(h \sin \theta)$, is the midpoint of the leading plateau and not the crossover, which sits at $R_2 = 2R_1$. A radial window whose upper limit lies below R_2 is therefore entirely pre-asymptotic, and a rate measured on such a window is not evidence about the exponential type.

7.5 RANK GROWTH LIES OUTSIDE CARLSON'S INTERPOLATION CLASS

The classical route to uniqueness for an interpolation problem is a Carlson-type theorem [4, Ch. 9]: a function of exponential type less than π on the imaginary axis, bounded on a half-plane, and vanishing on $\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, vanishes identically. Applying it here requires knowing the growth class of the objects involved, and that is now available in closed form.

Proposition 7.6 — The symbol has quadratic-logarithmic rank growth

Write B_n for the Bernoulli numbers with the convention $B_1 = -1/2$, and write $B_n(x)$ for the Bernoulli polynomials. Expand the kernel $((1 - e^{-t})(1 - e^{-ht}))^{-1}$ as $\sum_{n \geq -2} c_n(h)t^n$, with $c_{-2} = 1/h$, $c_{-1} = \frac{1+h}{2h}$, $c_0 = \frac{h^2+3h+1}{12h}$, and in general $c_n(h) = 1/h \sum_{j+k=n+2} B_j(1)B_k(1)h^k/(j!k!)$. Then, uniformly on every closed sector $|\arg a| \leq \pi - \delta$,

$$F_h(a) \sim -\frac{a^2 \log a}{2h} + \frac{3a^2}{4h} + \frac{(1+h)a(\log a - 1)}{2h} - \frac{(h^2 + 3h + 1) \log a}{12h} + \sum_{n \geq 1} c_n(h)(n-1)! a^{-n}. \quad (45)$$

Substituting $a_r = s + h - rh$ into (10) gives the rank asymptotic of $\mathcal{G}_h$, uniformly while a_r keeps a fixed angular distance from the negative real axis, which in the rank plane excludes a translated positive-real ray. In particular, for fixed x, s and $h > 0$,

$$\log |\mathcal{G}_h(x + iT, s)| = \frac{h}{2} T^2 \log T + \frac{h}{2} \left(\log \frac{h}{2\pi} - \frac{3}{2} \right) T^2 + O(T \log T). \quad (46)$$

Proof of Proposition 7.6. We first identify the coefficients in a right half-sector, where the Mellin representation converges. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and assume $|\arg a| \leq \pi/2 - \varepsilon$, so that $\operatorname{Re} a \geq c_\varepsilon |a| > 0$. For $\operatorname{Re} z > 2$ the double zeta then has the Mellin representation

$$\zeta_2(z, a | 1, h) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(z)} \int_0^\infty \frac{t^{z-1} e^{-at}}{(1 - e^{-t})(1 - e^{-ht})} dt, \quad (47)$$

obtained by expanding the geometric series and integrating term by term. Write $K(t)$ for the kernel and let $K(t) = \sum_{n \geq -2} c_n(h)t^n$ be its Laurent expansion at $t = 0$, which converges for $0 < t < 2\pi \min(1, h^{-1})$ and has the stated coefficients, since $t/(1 - e^{-t}) = \sum_{j \geq 0} B_j(1)t^j/j!$ gives $c_n(h) = h^{-1} \sum_{j+k=n+2} B_j(1)B_k(1)h^k/(j!k!)$.

Fix $M \geq 1$ and a compact set $\mathcal{K} \subset \{\operatorname{Re} z > -M - 1\}$, and split (47) as

$$\Gamma(z) \zeta_2(z, a | 1, h) = \int_0^1 t^{z-1} e^{-at} \left[K(t) - \sum_{n=-2}^M c_n t^n \right] dt + \sum_{n=-2}^M c_n \int_0^1 t^{z+n-1} e^{-at} dt + \int_1^\infty t^{z-1} e^{-at} K(t) dt.$$

The first integrand is $O(t^{\operatorname{Re} z + M})$ at the origin, so that term is holomorphic for $\operatorname{Re} z > -M - 1$. The remaining two are controlled by $\operatorname{Re} a \geq c_\varepsilon |a|$, and only by that: on the contour $(0, \infty)$ of (47) the factor e^{-at} grows exponentially when $\operatorname{Re} a < 0$, so the estimates of this paragraph are

asserted for $|\arg a| \leq \pi/2 - \varepsilon$ and nowhere else. There, for $|a| \geq 1$, the tail integral is entire in z and obeys the bound

$$\int_1^\infty t^{z-1} e^{-at} K(t) dt = O_{\varepsilon, \mathcal{K}}(e^{-c_\varepsilon |a|/2}),$$

uniformly for $z \in \mathcal{K}$, and completing each monomial integral from $\int_0^1$ to $\int_0^\infty$ produces $\Gamma(z+n)a^{-z-n}$ together with an error $\int_1^\infty t^{z+n-1} e^{-at} dt$ obeying the same bound. Hence, in the right half-sector $|\arg a| \leq \pi/2 - \varepsilon$,

$$\zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h) = \sum_{n=-2}^M c_n(h) \frac{\Gamma(z+n)}{\Gamma(z)} a^{-z-n} + E_M(z, a), \quad (48)$$

with $E_M(\cdot, a)$ holomorphic on $\{\operatorname{Re} z > -M-1\}$ and

$$E_M(z, a) = O_{\mathcal{K}, h, \varepsilon, M}(|a|^{-M-1})$$

uniformly for $z \in \mathcal{K}$, by Watson's lemma applied to the subtracted integrand. Because that bound is uniform on a compact neighbourhood of $z = 0$, Cauchy's estimate on a fixed circle about $z = 0$ transfers it to the derivative:

$$\partial_z E_M(0, a) = O_{h, \varepsilon, M}(|a|^{-M-1}). \quad (49)$$

Differentiate (48) at $z = 0$ and use $F_h(a) = \partial_z \zeta_2(z, a \mid 1, h)|_{z=0}$ from Definition 2.1. For $n \geq 1$ the factor $\Gamma(z+n)/\Gamma(z) = z(z+1) \cdots (z+n-1)$ vanishes to first order at $z = 0$, with derivative $(n-1)!$, contributing $c_n(h)(n-1)! a^{-n}$. For the exceptional indices the factor is a *reciprocal* of a rising product, and contributes at $z = 0$:

$$\frac{\Gamma(z-2)}{\Gamma(z)} = \frac{1}{(z-1)(z-2)}, \quad \frac{\Gamma(z-1)}{\Gamma(z)} = \frac{1}{z-1}, \quad \frac{\Gamma(z)}{\Gamma(z)} = 1. \quad (50)$$

These take the values $1/2, -1, 1$ and have derivatives $3/4, -1, 0$ at $z = 0$. Differentiating $c_n(h)(\Gamma(z+n)/\Gamma(z))a^{-z-n}$ at $z = 0$, the factor $a^{-z-n} = e^{-(z+n)\log a}$ supplying the logarithms, therefore gives $-\frac{a^2 \log a}{2h} + \frac{3a^2}{4h}$ at $n = -2$, $\frac{(1+h)a(\log a-1)}{2h}$ at $n = -1$ and $-\frac{(h^2+3h+1)\log a}{12h}$ at $n = 0$, after inserting $c_{-2} = 1/h$, $c_{-1} = \frac{1+h}{2h}$, $c_0 = \frac{h^2+3h+1}{12h}$. These are the first three terms of (45). With (49) controlling the tail, this establishes (45) on every closed right half-sector $|\arg a| \leq \pi/2 - \varepsilon$.

The extension of (48), together with its differentiated remainder (49), from the right half-sector to every closed slit sector $|\arg a| \leq \pi - \delta$ is supplied by [8, Prop. 2.3 and (3.13)–(3.15)]. The notation matches as follows. Ruijsenaars writes $\zeta_N(s, w \mid a_1, \dots, a_N)$ for the multiple zeta function and builds it from $f(t) = t^N \prod_{j=1}^N (1 - e^{-a_j t})^{-1}$ [8, (3.1)]. The present case is $N = 2$ with $a_1 = 1$, $a_2 = h$, so that $f(t) = t^2 K(t)$; his s is our z and his w is our a , so his ζ_2 is our $\zeta_2(\cdot, \cdot \mid 1, h)$ and his $\Psi_N(w) = \partial_s \zeta_N(s, w)|_{s=0}$ [8, (3.12)] is our $F_h(a)$. The cited expansion is therefore already the differentiated one, and no further passage through ∂_z is required. His truncation index is ours shifted by N : he subtracts the Taylor coefficients of f through order M' , which are the $c_n(h)$ of (48) for $n \leq M' - 2$, so $M' = M + 2$. With these identifications [8, Prop. 2.3] continues the remainder [8, (3.14)] holomorphically to $\mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0]$, and [8, (3.15)] bounds it by $O(|a|^{N-M'-1}) = O(|a|^{-M-1})$ uniformly on $|\arg a| \leq \pi - \delta$. So specialized, [8, (3.13)] is (45) term for term: its logarithmic

coefficient is $-1/2B_{2,2}(a)$, which is $-Q_h(a)$ for the polynomial Q_h of Theorem 4.3, and its remaining terms are the three exceptional terms and the tail $\sum_{n \geq 1} c_n(h)(n-1)!a^{-n}$ computed above. The half-sector computation is given in full because it identifies those coefficients from the present normalization rather than importing them.

For (46), put $a_r = s + h - rh$ with $r = x + iT$. Then $a_r = -ihT + O(1)$, so $|a_r| = hT + O(1)$ and $\arg a_r = -\pi/2 + O(T^{-1})$, which stays in a fixed subsector. Taking real parts in (45) through (10), the leading term contributes $h/2T^2 \log(hT)$, the term $3a^2/(4h)$ contributes $-\frac{3h}{4}T^2$, and the prefactor of (10) contributes $-h/2T^2 \log 2\pi$; the remaining terms are $O(T \log T)$. Collecting the three contributions gives (46). $\square$

The expansion fixes the growth class of each of the three objects involved. By (46), $\mathcal{G}_h$ has quadratic-logarithmic growth in the rank variable: it is not of exponential type at all, so no order-one hypothesis applies to it, and a slope measured on a finite window of $\log |\mathcal{G}_h|$ along a vertical line describes that window, not an exponential type. The multiplicative ambiguity $\exp(E_\varphi)$ has infinite entire order, so it lies outside an order-one theorem as well, even though its logarithm E_φ has order one and type $2\pi p$. Finally, the difficulty is *not* that the classical threshold π is too small: an axiom bounding the relevant type below π is stricter than one bounding it below 2π , and would exclude E_φ if it could legitimately be imposed. What obstructs the argument is the mismatch of growth classes between the theorem and the objects, not the size of the constant.

The uniformity in Proposition 7.6 is genuinely sectorial: along the excluded ray the remainder degrades rather than averaging away, and no uniform inverse-power bound survives as the angular distance to that ray shrinks to zero. Any statement derived from (45) must carry its sector with it.

Remark 7.2 (Log-convexity is not a Bohr–Møllerup substitute). The one classical route left — fixing the continuation by log-convexity in the rank variable, as Bohr–Møllerup fixes Γ — is also unavailable, and a single exact value settles it. At $h = 1$,

$$\log \mathcal{G}_1(2, 10) - 2 \log \mathcal{G}_1(1, 10) + \log \mathcal{G}_1(0, 10) = \log \frac{2\pi}{9} < 0, \quad (51)$$

so one second difference is negative and no global convexity axiom in r can hold.

7.6 SPECTRAL ASYMPTOTICS FORCE RATIO-NORMALIZED UNIQUENESS

Growth in the rank variable is not the only route. The unit-step recurrence of Theorem 4.2 is in s , and an asymptotic normalization in that variable settles the question outright. The substantial statement is the expansion; the uniqueness principle is a one-line consequence of it.

Proposition 7.7 — Uniform spectral asymptotics

Fix $h > 0$, a compact $K \subset \mathbb{C}$, an integer $M \geq 1$ and $\delta > 0$. Throughout this proposition $\log \mathcal{G}_h$ denotes the lift (10), with the principal logarithm on the stated slit sector; a different lift differs by a constant in $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$, which cannot be absorbed into the remainder. Put

$$S_m(r; h) = \sum_{k=0}^m \binom{m}{k} B_{m-k}(-h)^k \frac{B_{k+1}(r) - B_{k+1}}{k+1}. \quad (52)$$

Then, uniformly for $r \in K$ and $s \rightarrow \infty$ in $|\arg s| \leq \pi - \delta$,

$$\log \mathcal{G}_h(r, s) = rs(\log s - 1) + A_h(r) \log \frac{2\pi}{s} + \sum_{n=1}^M \frac{(-1)^{n+1} S_{n+1}(r; h)}{n(n+1)s^n} + O_{K,h,\delta,M}(|s|^{-M-1}). \quad (53)$$

Proof of Proposition 7.7. Apply Proposition 7.6 at the two endpoints $a = s + h - rh$ and $a = s + h$ of (10). Since r ranges over a compact set, both endpoints satisfy $a = s + O_K(1)$ and remain in a common closed slit sector for large $|s|$, so the re-expansion of each term in powers of s^{-1} is uniform on K and the two error terms combine to $O_{K,h,\delta,M}(|s|^{-M-1})$.

Collecting, the difference of the two expansions produces $rs(\log s - 1)$ from the quadratic and linear terms and $-A_h(r) \log s$ from the logarithmic ones, while the prefactor of (10) supplies $A_h(r) \log(2\pi)$. For each $n \geq 1$ the coefficient of s^{-n} is obtained from finitely many binomial expansions of $(s + h(1-r))^\pm$ and $\log(s + h(1-r))$, so it is a polynomial in r , written $C_n(r; h)$, of degree at most $n+2$.

It remains to identify C_n . At $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, Theorem 3.1 gives

$$\log \mathcal{G}_h(N, s) = \frac{hN(N-1)}{2} \log(2\pi) + \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \log \Gamma(s - jh),$$

and the shifted Stirling expansion

$$\log \Gamma(s + a) \sim s(\log s - 1) + \left(a - \frac{1}{2}\right) \log s + \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) + \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^{n+1} B_{n+1}(a)}{n(n+1)s^n},$$

applied with $a = -jh$ and summed over $0 \leq j < N$, gives leading term $Ns(\log s - 1)$, logarithmic coefficient $-\left[\frac{hN(N-1)}{2} + N/2\right] = -A_h(N)$, constant term $N/2 \log(2\pi)$ which together with the prefactor is $A_h(N) \log(2\pi)$, and

$$C_n(N; h) = \frac{(-1)^{n+1}}{n(n+1)} \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} B_{n+1}(-hj).$$

Expanding $B_m(-hj) = \sum_k \binom{m}{k} B_{m-k}(-h)^k$ and applying Faulhaber's identity

$$\sum_{j=0}^{N-1} j^k = \frac{B_{k+1}(N) - B_{k+1}}{k+1},$$

valid for every $k \geq 0$ in the convention $B_1 = -1/2$, gives $\sum_{j=0}^{N-1} B_m(-hj) = S_m(N; h)$. So $C_n(r; h)$ and $(-1)^{n+1} S_{n+1}(r; h)/(n(n+1))$ are polynomials in r of bounded degree agreeing at every nonnegative integer, hence agree identically. $\square$

Corollary 7.8 — Uniqueness under ratio normalization

Let $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h$ be meromorphic and satisfy the same meromorphic shift quotient (19) in s as $\mathcal{G}_h$, and suppose $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h(r, s)/\mathcal{G}_h(r, s) \rightarrow 1$ uniformly on compact rank sets as $s \rightarrow \infty$ in one closed sector containing the positive real ray. Then $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h = \mathcal{G}_h$.

Proof of Corollary 7.8. Put $H = \tilde{\mathcal{G}}_h/\mathcal{G}_h$. Dividing the two shift relations gives $H(r, s+1) = H(r, s)$, so H equals each of its positive integer translates and therefore equals their limit, which is 1. A pole would repeat under every translation and contradict that limit, so H is holomorphic and identically 1. $\square$

By Proposition 7.7 the symbol itself satisfies the hypothesis, so the normalization is not vacuous. Agreement of the leading term $rs(\log s - 1)$ alone does not suffice, since a coboundary is $O(1)$ and survives it; the ratio itself must tend to 1.

The algebraic identities determine the symbol only up to the entire logarithmic deformations of Theorem 7.3. Rank-growth hypotheses do not remove them, because Proposition 7.6 places both $\mathcal{G}_h$ and the multiplicative ambiguity outside the order-one setting, and log-convexity fails by Remark 7.2. The spectral ratio normalization of Corollary 7.8 does remove them, and uniquely determines $\mathcal{G}_h$.

8 CELL GEOMETRY TURNS JACK–RIESZ POSITIVITY INTO A LATTICE PROBLEM

The Gindikin gamma normalizes the Riesz distributions of a cone, and the parameters at which those distributions are positive form the *Wallach set*: for a cone of rank R and multiplicity d , the union of the discrete ladder $\{0, d/2, \dots, (R-1)d/2\}$ with the ray $[(R-1)d/2, \infty)$ [6, Ch. VII, Ch. XIII]. If the rank can be continued, one wants to know what becomes of that set. For the formal Jack pairing the answer has a definite shape. Positivity survives at fractional rank, but the unbounded ray disappears: the all-degree locus is bounded, and at rational steps it contains a closed cell chamber around the balanced point, while the initial finite-cutoff band may subsequently erode or fragment. The erosion proceeds by a mechanism that can be identified cell by cell — and that, for some multiplicities, provably comes to a stop.

The two halves of the paper study the same affine root products through two different questions. The first half asks when the continued spectral recurrence terminates to finite polynomial data; the second asks the weaker question of sign coherence. Both reduce the gamma envelope to affine root products: the shift quotient $R_{r,h}$ is a one-dimensional falling factorial, while each Jack–Riesz pivot is the product of one cell polynomial evaluated at the rank point rD and at the spectral point s . Polynomial termination forces nonnegative integral rank; coherent signs persist inside cell chambers at nonintegral rank. Sections 8–11 study that separation in detail.

8.1 THE JACK BASIS DIAGONALIZES THE FORMAL PAIRING

Throughout Part II, $D = h = d/2$: the Barnes step of Part I and the Jack parameter here are the same number. Fix $d > 0$ and write $D = d/2$ and $\alpha = 1/D$. The polynomial identities below are valid for complex r and s . Every statement involving order, sign, positivity, $[r]$, $[r]$, the defect ν , or a positivity locus is henceforth restricted to real r and s . The band, erosion, and stable-locus results are stated for $r > 0$ unless said otherwise. All statements below concern the formal pairing built from the following two ingredients, each of which is a polynomial in r and therefore continues off the integers without choice.

Definition 8.1 (The formal Jack–Riesz pairing). Fix $D > 0$, write $\alpha = 1/D$, and for a partition $\lambda = (\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \dots)$ write $(i, j) \in \lambda$ for the cells of its Young diagram. For a cell $c = (i, j)$ let $a_\lambda(c) = \lambda_i - j$ and $\ell_\lambda(c) = \lambda'_j - i$ be its arm and leg lengths, and put

$$H_\lambda(D) = \prod_{c \in \lambda} \left(\frac{a_\lambda(c)}{D} + \ell_\lambda(c) + 1 \right) > 0, \quad (54)$$

the monic Jack hook product [12, Ch. VI, §10], [15], positive because $D > 0$. Set

$$F_{\lambda,D}(x) = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} (x - (i-1)D + (j-1)), \quad \pi_{\lambda}(s) = \frac{F_{\lambda,D}(rD) F_{\lambda,D}(s)}{D^{|\lambda|} H_{\lambda}(D)}. \quad (55)$$

For real r and s let $V_N^{\mathbb{R}} = \text{span}_{\mathbb{R}}\{P_{\lambda}^{(\alpha)} : |\lambda| \leq N\}$. The *formal Jack–Riesz pairing* at cutoff N is the real symmetric bilinear form on $V_N^{\mathbb{R}}$ determined by

$$\left\langle \sum_{\lambda} a_{\lambda} P_{\lambda}^{(\alpha)}, \sum_{\lambda} b_{\lambda} P_{\lambda}^{(\alpha)} \right\rangle_{r,s} = \sum_{|\lambda| \leq N} a_{\lambda} b_{\lambda} \pi_{\lambda}(s). \quad (56)$$

It is positive semidefinite exactly when $\pi_{\lambda}(s) \geq 0$ for every λ with $|\lambda| \leq N$, and its kernel is the real span of those $P_{\lambda}^{(\alpha)}$ with $\pi_{\lambda}(s) = 0$.

The loci this section computes are named once, here. For real r and $d > 0$ put

$$\mathcal{W}_N(r, d) = \{s \in \mathbb{R} : \pi_{\lambda}(s) \geq 0 \text{ for every } |\lambda| \leq N\}, \quad \mathcal{W}_{\infty}(r, d) = \bigcap_{N \geq 0} \mathcal{W}_N(r, d). \quad (57)$$

Thus $\mathcal{W}_N(r, d)$ is the set of spectral parameters at which the pairing of (56) is positive semidefinite at cutoff N , and $\mathcal{W}_{\infty}(r, d)$ — the *all-degree locus* — is the set at which it is positive semidefinite at every cutoff simultaneously. Since enlarging N only adds constraints, the map $N \mapsto \mathcal{W}_N(r, d)$ is nonincreasing.

The pairing is taken over $\mathbb{R}$ deliberately. A nonzero *symmetric* bilinear form on a complex vector space is never positive semidefinite, since $B(iv, iv) = -B(v, v)$; if a complex space is wanted, extend (56) sesquilinearly, $\langle \sum a_{\lambda} P_{\lambda}, \sum b_{\lambda} P_{\lambda} \rangle = \sum a_{\lambda} \overline{b_{\lambda}} \pi_{\lambda}(s)$, which is Hermitian and gives the identical positivity criterion.

The pairing is diagonal by construction, so no triangular reduction is involved and the null modes are individual Jack polynomials. Its relation to the classical Riesz functional is a specialization statement rather than a definition: at $r = N \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ and $\alpha = 2/d$ the numbers $\pi_{\lambda}(s)$ are the diagonal entries produced by the Gram matrix of the Jack basis against the Riesz functional of the cone [6, 5], so Definition 8.1 continues that diagonal in r . Nothing below uses more than (55).

Two classical quantities are recovered from (55), and it is worth recording the translation. The numerator of the evaluation $P_{\lambda}^{(\alpha)}(1^r)$ and the generalized Pochhammer symbol are

$$\Pi_{\lambda}(r) = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} (r - (i-1) + \alpha(j-1)) = D^{-|\lambda|} F_{\lambda,D}(rD), \quad (s)_{\lambda}^{(\alpha)} = F_{\lambda,D}(s), \quad (58)$$

both by comparison of (55) cell by cell after the substitution $\alpha = 1/D$. The rank numerator is thus $F_{\lambda,D}$ evaluated at rD , up to the scalar $D^{-|\lambda|}$, and the spectral factor is the same polynomial evaluated at s ; so both factors of (55) are values of one lattice polynomial at two points, and

$$\text{sign } \pi_{\lambda}(s) = \text{sign } F_{\lambda,D}(rD) \cdot \text{sign } F_{\lambda,D}(s). \quad (59)$$

Equation (59) gathers the whole mechanism of this section into one object: the rank factor $F_{\lambda,D}(rD)$ carries the rank-null ideal, the spectral factor $F_{\lambda,D}(s)$ carries the null lattice, and a

pivot is negative exactly when the two disagree in sign. Both factors are exact products of affine forms, so every locus below is an algebraic cell decomposition of the real s -axis computed in exact rational arithmetic, not sampled.

Because the Jack basis diagonalizes the pairing, the finite-cutoff Gram determinant is immediate, and it packages every wall and multiplicity into one formula.

Proposition 8.2 — The finite-cutoff Gram determinant

Write $\xi_{ij} = (i - 1)D - (j - 1)$ for the cell roots and

$$m_N(i, j) = \#\{\lambda : |\lambda| \leq N, (i, j) \in \lambda\} \quad (60)$$

for the number of admitted diagrams containing the cell (i, j) . Then the Gram matrix $G_N(r, s)$ of the pairing on V_N , in the Jack basis, is diagonal with entries $\pi_\lambda(s)$, and

$$\det G_N(r, s) = C_{N,D} \prod_{i,j \geq 1} (rD - \xi_{ij})^{m_N(i,j)} (s - \xi_{ij})^{m_N(i,j)}, \quad C_{N,D} = \prod_{|\lambda| \leq N} \frac{1}{D^{|\lambda|} H_\lambda(D)} > 0, \quad (61)$$

the product running over the finitely many cells lying in some diagram of degree at most N .

Proof of Proposition 8.2. Diagonality is Definition 8.1, so $\det G_N = \prod_{|\lambda| \leq N} \pi_\lambda(s)$. By (55) each $\pi_\lambda(s)$ is $F_{\lambda,D}(rD)F_{\lambda,D}(s)/(D^{|\lambda|}H_\lambda(D))$, and $F_{\lambda,D}(x) = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} (x - \xi_{ij})$. Collecting the cells across all admitted diagrams replaces the product over diagrams by a product over cells with exponent $m_N(i, j)$. Positivity of $C_{N,D}$ is positivity of $H_\lambda(D)$ for $D > 0$. $\square$

The divisor of (61) is the complete finite-cutoff picture: the rank walls $rD = \xi_{ij}$, which are the rank-null cells of Proposition 9.6, the spectral walls $s = \xi_{ij}$, which are the null lattice of Lemma 9.4, and their multiplicities. The sections below take this divisor apart mode by mode; (61) is the global algebraic summary.

8.2 THE PIVOTS ARE FIXED-RANK SLICES OF JACK z -MEASURE WEIGHTS

The pivots (55) are not new objects. Up to a factor constant on each degree they are the weights of the Jack z -measures of Borodin and Olshanski [3], restricted to the slice on which the two free parameters are the rescaled rank and the spectral variable. Recording the dictionary once fixes what in this section is established background and what is not.

Borodin and Olshanski classify the parameters giving strictly positive weights into a principal and a complementary series [3, Prop. 1.2], and exhibit row, column, and fat-hook degenerate series [3, Prop. 1.3, Prop. 1.4], the last supported exactly on diagrams contained in a fat hook; Petrov [13] later gives a characterization of the Jack z -measures together with their degenerations. Under the fixed-rank slice below, the integral-defect rank-null ideal is one of those fat-hook degenerations: the diagrams surviving it satisfy $\lambda_{k+1} \leq \nu$, which is containment in the fat hook with arm k and leg ν . What is new here is the determination of the complete closed

semidefinite locus along that slice, including its finite-cutoff erosion, its isolated boundary points, and its exact stabilization degree.

Borodin and Olshanski fix $\theta > 0$ and set, for a partition λ with $n = |\lambda|$ boxes,

$$(z)_{\lambda, \theta} = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} (z + (j-1) - (i-1)\theta), \quad (62)$$

$$H(\lambda, \theta) = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} ((\lambda_i - j) + (\lambda'_j - i)\theta + 1), \quad H'(\lambda, \theta) = \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} ((\lambda_i - j) + (\lambda'_j - i)\theta + \theta), \quad (63)$$

and, with $t = zz' / \theta$,

$$M_{z, z', \theta}^{(n)}(\lambda) = \frac{n! (z)_{\lambda, \theta} (z')_{\lambda, \theta}}{(t)_n H(\lambda, \theta) H'(\lambda, \theta)}, \quad (64)$$

which is a probability measure on the partitions of n for every admissible choice of the two parameters [3, §1].

Proposition 8.3 — The pivots are fixed-rank slices of Jack z-measure weights

Put $\theta = D$, $z = rD$, $z' = s$ and $n = |\lambda|$. Then $F_{\lambda, D}(x) = (x)_{\lambda, D}$ and $D^n H_\lambda(D) = H'(\lambda, D)$, so

$$\pi_\lambda(s) = \frac{(z)_{\lambda, D} (z')_{\lambda, D}}{H'(\lambda, D)} = \frac{(rs)_n H(\lambda, D)}{n!} M_{rD, s, D}^{(n)}(\lambda), \quad (65)$$

the second equality wherever $(rs)_n \neq 0$. Both hook products are positive, so within a fixed degree n the pivots and the z -measure weights differ by the single λ -independent sign $\text{sign}(rs)_n$.

Proof of Proposition 8.3. Cell by cell, $x - (i-1)D + (j-1) = x + (j-1) - (i-1)D$, which is the first identity. For the second, (54) gives $D^n H_\lambda(D) = \prod_{c \in \lambda} (a_\lambda(c) + D \ell_\lambda(c) + D)$, and $a_\lambda(i, j) = \lambda_i - j$, $\ell_\lambda(i, j) = \lambda'_j - i$, so the product is $H'(\lambda, D)$. Substituting both into (55) gives the first equality of (65); solving (64) for $(z)_{\lambda, D} (z')_{\lambda, D}$ and inserting $t = zz' / \theta = rs$ gives the second. Positivity of H and H' is immediate from $\theta = D > 0$ and $a_\lambda, \ell_\lambda \geq 0$. $\square$

Two mechanisms used below are therefore established background rather than new. Borodin and Olshanski classify the parameters at which (64) is strictly positive for every n and every λ : a principal series with $z' = \bar{z}$, and, for rational θ , a complementary series in which z and z' are real and lie strictly between the same two consecutive points of $\mathbb{Z} + \mathbb{Z}\theta$ [3, §1]. On the slice $(z, z', \theta) = (rD, s, D)$ that lattice is the content set Λ_D of (70), so Theorem 8.4 is the slice form of their complementary series: the chamber *interior* corresponds to strictly positive complementary parameters, while the chamber boundary is semidefinite degeneration. They also record the conjugation symmetry

$$(z, z', \theta, \lambda) \mapsto \left(-\frac{z}{\theta}, -\frac{z'}{\theta}, \frac{1}{\theta}, \lambda'\right), \quad (66)$$

which on the same slice is exactly the involution $(r, d) \mapsto (-rD, 4/d)$ of Theorem 11.1; and their degenerate series contains the integral-rank length ideal recovered in Theorem 8.5.

What that work does not settle is what this section is about. The z -measure classification is a statement of *strict* positivity of the whole family, at all degrees at once, over the two free parameters (z, z') . Fixing the rank and moving only the spectral parameter turns the question into one about a single real line, where the answer is a closed *semidefinite* locus with boundary — retained ladder points, a bounded band, isolated points above it — rather than an open chamber. The results below compute those loci exactly (Theorem 9.1, Theorem 10.1, Corollary 10.6), classify the stable locus at integral defect, and determine the first cutoff at which the band loses a point and the exact degree at which it stops moving (Theorem 9.9, Corollary 10.7). Finite-degree erosion in particular has no counterpart in an all-degree classification: it is invisible until a diagram of the critical size is admitted, and its cutoff $N_* = v([r] + 1)$ is a statement about the truncated form, not about the family.

Remark 8.1 (The two-point cell kernel). The positivity theory below is not fundamentally about rank. Every statement is about two evaluations of one cell polynomial, and it is worth naming the object once. Put

$$\Pi_{\lambda,D}(x, y) = \frac{F_{\lambda,D}(x) F_{\lambda,D}(y)}{D^{|\lambda|} H_{\lambda}(D)}, \quad (67)$$

so that $\pi_{\lambda}(s) = \Pi_{\lambda,D}(rD, s)$ is the slice $x = rD, y = s$. In this form three facts are immediate and account for most of what follows. Real x, y in one closed content chamber give $\Pi_{\lambda,D}(x, y) \geq 0$ for every λ , and in one open chamber give strict positivity away from the null ideal; that is Theorem 8.4. The Hermitian specialization $y = \bar{x}$ gives

$$\Pi_{\lambda,D}(x, \bar{x}) = \frac{|F_{\lambda,D}(x)|^2}{D^{|\lambda|} H_{\lambda}(D)} \geq 0, \quad (68)$$

the complex principal-series companion to the real complementary-series statement. And conjugation of partitions acts by

$$(D, x, y, \lambda) \mapsto (D^{-1}, -x/D, -y/D, \lambda'), \quad (69)$$

preserving all signs; that is Theorem 11.1. The chamber theorem and the duality are therefore two faces of the same two-point kernel, seen along different slices.

8.3 CONTENT CHAMBERS FORCE ALL-DEGREE POSITIVITY

Equation (59) has an immediate consequence that the rest of the section repeatedly rediscovers in special cases. Every cell contributes the same root to both factors, so the two factors can disagree in sign only if a root separates rD from s . Naming the set of those roots turns the observation into a theorem.

Theorem 8.4 — Cell-lattice chamber positivity

Let $D > 0$ and $r \in \mathbb{R}$, and define the *content set*

$$\Lambda_D = \{(i-1)D - (j-1) : i, j \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}\}. \quad (70)$$

Suppose $rD \notin \Lambda_D$ and the open interval with endpoints rD and s contains no point of Λ_D . Then $\pi_\lambda(s) \geq 0$ for every partition λ , and if also $s \notin \Lambda_D$ then every pivot is strictly positive. Consequently the closed cell chamber containing rD lies in $\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d)$, and the pairing is positive definite on its interior.

If $D = a/b$ in lowest terms, then the content set is the *content grid* $\Lambda_D = b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, so whenever $ar \notin \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\left[\frac{\lfloor ar \rfloor}{b}, \frac{\lfloor ar \rfloor + 1}{b} \right] \subseteq \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d), \quad (71)$$

with positive definiteness on the open interval.

Proof of Theorem 8.4. Each cell $c = (i, j)$ contributes the root $\xi_c = (i-1)D - (j-1) \in \Lambda_D$, so that (55) reads $F_{\lambda,D}(x) = \prod_{c \in \lambda} (x - \xi_c)$.

Fix a cell c . By hypothesis ξ_c does not lie strictly between rD and s , so $rD - \xi_c$ and $s - \xi_c$ are either of the same sign or the second vanishes; the first cannot vanish because $rD \notin \Lambda_D$. Hence $(rD - \xi_c)(s - \xi_c) \geq 0$ for every cell, and multiplying over λ gives $F_{\lambda,D}(rD)F_{\lambda,D}(s) \geq 0$. Since $D^{|\lambda|}H_\lambda(D) > 0$, (59) yields $\pi_\lambda(s) \geq 0$. If $s \notin \Lambda_D$ as well, no factor vanishes and the pivot is strictly positive. As the argument is cellwise it holds for every λ at once, hence at every degree.

For the lattice computation write $D = a/b$ with $\gcd(a, b) = 1$. Every element of Λ_D has the form $mD - n = (am - bn)/b$ with $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, so $\Lambda_D \subseteq b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$. Conversely, given $z \in \mathbb{Z}$, choose $m \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ with $am \equiv z \pmod{b}$ and $am \geq z$, which is possible since $\gcd(a, b) = 1$; then $n = (am - z)/b \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and $z/b = mD - n \in \Lambda_D$. So $\Lambda_D = b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, whose chambers are the intervals $[z/b, (z+1)/b]$. The point $rD = ar/b$ lies in the interior of one of them precisely when $ar \notin \mathbb{Z}$, and that chamber is (71). $\square$

For irrational D the content set is dense in $\mathbb{R}$: the numbers $mD - n$ with $m, n \geq 0$ accumulate everywhere by equidistribution of $\{mD\}$. There is then no nondegenerate chamber, and Theorem 8.4 gives only the balanced point itself. This is the structural reason the rational and irrational steps behave differently, and it is the mechanism behind every continuous interval found in the rest of this section.

One point of the chamber requires no hypothesis on the step at all, and it is the point the chamber is centred on.

At the balanced point $s = rD$ the two factors of (55) coincide, so

$$\pi_\lambda(rD) = \frac{F_{\lambda,D}(rD)^2}{D^{|\lambda|}H_\lambda(D)} \geq 0 \quad (72)$$

for every λ : the point $s = rD$ is positive semidefinite at every rank and every cutoff, integer or not. Fractional-rank positivity is therefore not an accident of small cutoffs but a structural feature anchored at $s = rD$.

8.4 INTEGER RANKS RECOVER THE CLASSICAL WALLACH SET

At integer rank the pairing is under complete control, and the classical Wallach set is recovered at every cutoff past the rank. This is the fixed point against which every fractional-rank statement below is read.

Theorem 8.5 — Integer rank recovers the classical Wallach set

Let $R \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, let $d > 0$, write $D = d/2$, and let $N \geq R$. Then

$$\mathcal{W}_N(R, d) = \{jD : 0 \leq j < R - 1\} \cup [(R - 1)D, \infty). \quad (73)$$

In particular the locus is independent of the cutoff once $N \geq R$, so it equals $\mathcal{W}_\infty(R, d)$: the discrete ladder together with an unbounded ray. For arbitrary $d > 0$, this is the formal Wallach-shaped locus of the continued pairing. Whenever (R, d) is realized by a symmetric cone, it is the classical Wallach set of that cone.

Proof of Theorem 8.5. A cell (i, j) contributes $D(R - i + 1) + (j - 1)$ to $F_{\lambda, D}(RD)$ and $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1)$ to $F_{\lambda, D}(s)$.

Step 1 (the rank factor is a length ideal). For $i \leq R$ the rank factor is at least $D(R - i + 1) \geq D > 0$. For $i = R + 1$ and $j = 1$ it is $D(R - R) + 0 = 0$. Hence $F_{\lambda, D}(RD) > 0$ when $\ell(\lambda) \leq R$ and $F_{\lambda, D}(RD) = 0$ when $\ell(\lambda) > R$; in the latter case $\pi_\lambda \equiv 0$. So by (59) the sign of $\pi_\lambda(s)$ is that of $F_{\lambda, D}(s)$ for every λ of length at most R , and every longer λ imposes no constraint at all.

Step 2 (the ray). Let $s \geq (R - 1)D$ and $\ell(\lambda) \leq R$. Every spectral factor satisfies $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1) \geq s - (R - 1)D \geq 0$, so $F_{\lambda, D}(s) \geq 0$ and $\pi_\lambda(s) \geq 0$. Thus $[(R - 1)D, \infty) \subseteq \mathcal{W}_N(R, d)$.

Step 3 (the ladder points). Fix j with $0 \leq j < R - 1$ and put $s = jD$. If $\ell(\lambda) \leq j$ then every spectral factor is at least $jD - (j - 1)D = D > 0$ and the pivot is positive. If $j + 1 \leq \ell(\lambda) \leq R$ then the cell $(j + 1, 1)$ contributes $jD - jD = 0$, so $F_{\lambda, D}(s) = 0$ and the pivot vanishes. Either way $\pi_\lambda(jD) \geq 0$.

Step 4 (the gaps and the negative axis). Fix j with $0 \leq j \leq R - 2$ and $s \in (jD, (j + 1)D)$, and take the column $\lambda = (1^{j+2})$. Its height satisfies $j + 2 \leq R$, so it is not rank-null, and $|\lambda| = j + 2 \leq R \leq N$, so it is admitted at cutoff N . Its spectral factors are $s - (i - 1)D$ for $1 \leq i \leq j + 2$: positive for $i \leq j + 1$ since $s > jD$, and negative at $i = j + 2$ since $s < (j + 1)D$. Exactly one factor is negative, so $\pi_\lambda(s) < 0$ and the whole gap is excluded. For $s < 0$ the partition (1) has positive rank factor RD and negative spectral factor s , so $s \notin \mathcal{W}_N(R, d)$.

The four steps exhaust $\mathbb{R}$ and give (73). The right-hand side does not depend on N , and $N \mapsto \mathcal{W}_N$ is nonincreasing with every member equal to it, so the intersection over all N is that set as well. $\square$

The classical cases are the specializations: $(R, d) = (2, 2)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [1, \infty)$; $(2, 4)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [2, \infty)$; $(2, 8)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [4, \infty)$; and the Albert case $(3, 8)$ gives $\{0\} \cup \{4\} \cup [8, \infty)$, ladder points and continuous ray in the right places [6, Ch. XIII].

9 FRACTIONAL RANK CAPS THE WALLACH RAY, THEN NULL IDEALS GOVERN ITS EROSION

Departure from the integer-rank benchmark is measured by one number. This section introduces it, shows that it caps the classical ray, and then identifies the null ideals through which it decides whether the surviving locus erodes.

9.1 FRACTIONAL RANK REPLACES THE TERMINAL RAY BY A CAPPED INITIAL LOCUS

For real $r > 0$ it is convenient to name the quantity that measures how far the rank sits below the next integer. Define the *defect*

$$\nu = \nu(r, d) = D(\lceil r \rceil - r) \geq 0, \quad (74)$$

which vanishes exactly at integer rank and equals D times the fractional deficiency $\lceil r \rceil - r$. In a cell of row $i = \lceil r \rceil + 1 + t$ and column j the rank factor of (58) takes the value

$$r - (i - 1) + \alpha(j - 1) = \frac{(j - 1) - \nu - tD}{D}, \quad (75)$$

by direct substitution of i and $\alpha = 1/D$. The sign of a rank factor is thus governed entirely by the lattice position of $(j - 1)$ relative to $\nu + tD$. Within a fixed rank strip $k - 1 < r < k$, the continuous dependence on r enters through the defect $\nu = D(k - r)$; the integer $k = \lceil r \rceil$ separately fixes the critical row, the ladder length, the cap, the witness degrees and the stabilization threshold. The first structural fact is that continuing the rank does not merely deform the Wallach set — it changes its topology.

Theorem 9.1 — Positive fractional rank replaces the terminal ray by a bounded initial locus

Let $r > 0$ be real with $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, write $k = \lceil r \rceil$, and set

$$N_{\text{er}}(r, d) = \min\{|\lambda| : \pi_\lambda(s) < 0 \text{ for some } s \in [\lceil r \rceil D, kD]\} \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} \cup \{\infty\}, \quad (76)$$

the least degree at which the band carries a negative pivot, with the convention $\min \emptyset = \infty$. Then $N_{\text{er}} \geq k + 2$, and for every cutoff N with $k + 1 \leq N < N_{\text{er}}$ one has $\mathcal{W}_N(r, d) = \mathcal{W}_{\text{pre}}(r, d)$, where

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{pre}}(r, d) = \left\{ j \frac{d}{2} : 0 \leq j < \lceil r \rceil \right\} \cup \left[\lceil r \rceil \frac{d}{2}, \lceil r \rceil \frac{d}{2} \right]. \quad (77)$$

In particular the terminal ray of the integer-rank Wallach set is replaced by the single bounded ladder interval containing $rd/2$.

Proof of Theorem 9.1. Throughout, a cell (i, j) contributes $D(r - i + 1) + (j - 1)$ to $F_{\lambda, D}(rD)$ and $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1)$ to $F_{\lambda, D}(s)$.

Rows above the band index are harmless. If $i \leq k$ then $r - i + 1 > 0$, so every cell in rows $1, \dots, k$ contributes a positive rank factor. If moreover $s > \lfloor r \rfloor D = (k - 1)D$ then $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1) \geq s - (k - 1)D > 0$ for $i \leq k$, so those cells contribute positive spectral factors as well. Hence any λ with at most k rows has $\pi_\lambda(s) > 0$ at every s in the open band. The unique partition of size $k + 1$ with more than k rows is the column (1^{k+1}) ; its cell $(k + 1, 1)$ contributes the single negative rank factor $-\nu$ and, for s in the open band, the single negative spectral factor $s - kD < 0$, so its pivot is positive as well. No partition of size at most $k + 1$ therefore carries a negative pivot on the band, and since N_{er} is an integer or ∞ , $N_{\text{er}} \geq k + 2$, so in particular the stated range of N is not empty.

The band lies in the locus. By (76) no λ with $|\lambda| < N_{\text{er}}$ takes a negative value anywhere on $[\lfloor r \rfloor D, kD]$, so for $N < N_{\text{er}}$ every pivot is nonnegative there.

The ladder points lie in the locus. Fix j with $0 \leq j < \lfloor r \rfloor$ and put $s = jD$. If λ has at most j rows then all its rank factors are positive, as above, and its spectral factors satisfy $s - (i - 1)D + (j' - 1) \geq jD - (j - 1)D = D > 0$; the pivot is positive. If λ has at least $j + 1$ rows then the cell $(j + 1, 1)$ contributes $jD - jD = 0$, so $F_{\lambda,D}(s) = 0$ and the pivot vanishes. Either way $\pi_\lambda(jD) \geq 0$.

The gaps below the band are excluded. Fix j with $0 \leq j < \lfloor r \rfloor$ and $s \in (jD, (j + 1)D)$, and take $\lambda = (1^{j+2})$, a column of height $j + 2 \leq \lfloor r \rfloor + 1 = k \leq N$. Since $j + 2 \leq k$ all its rank factors are positive. Its spectral factors are $s - (i - 1)D$ for $1 \leq i \leq j + 2$; these are positive for $i \leq j + 1$ and negative for $i = j + 2$, because $s < (j + 1)D$. Exactly one factor is negative, so $\pi_\lambda(s) < 0$.

Negative s is excluded. For $s < 0$ the partition $\lambda = (1)$ has $F_{\lambda,D}(rD) = rD > 0$ and $F_{\lambda,D}(s) = s < 0$.

Above the band is excluded. Since $N \geq k + 1$, Proposition 9.2 applies and removes every $s > kD$.

The five cases exhaust $\mathbb{R}$, and together they identify the locus with (77). □

Thus $(3/2, 8)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [4, 8]$, $(3/2, 2)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [1, 2]$, $(3/2, 4)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [2, 4]$, $(3/2, 6)$ gives $\{0\} \cup [3, 6]$, and $(5/2, 8)$ gives $\{0, 4\} \cup [8, 12]$. The band begins at the ladder point $\lfloor r \rfloor d/2$, not at the continued Wallach edge $(r - 1)d/2$: at $(3/2, 8)$ the latter equals 2 while the band begins at 4. It is also bounded above, which no integer-rank Wallach set is.

The band is bounded above at every sufficiently large cutoff, for every $d > 0$ and with no hypothesis on the defect. The witnesses have degree at most $\lfloor r \rfloor + 1$, so the bound is already a finite-degree statement; below that degree the computed locus is genuinely unbounded above.

Proposition 9.2 — A single column caps every positive fractional-rank locus

Let $r > 0$, $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, and $d > 0$, and set $D = d/2$. Then for every degree $M \geq \lfloor r \rfloor + 1$,

$$\mathcal{W}_M(r, d) \subseteq [0, D\lfloor r \rfloor], \quad \text{hence} \quad \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d) \subseteq [0, D\lfloor r \rfloor]. \quad (78)$$

Proof of Proposition 9.2. Set $m = \lceil r \rceil + 1$ and take $\lambda = (1^m)$, the single column of height m . Its cells are $(i, 1)$ for $1 \leq i \leq m$, so (55) gives

$$F_{\lambda,D}(x) = \prod_{q=0}^{m-1} (x - qD), \quad \text{hence} \quad F_{\lambda,D}(rD) = D^m \prod_{q=0}^{m-1} (r - q).$$

Since r is not an integer, $r - q > 0$ for $0 \leq q \leq \lceil r \rceil - 1$ and $r - \lceil r \rceil < 0$, so the product has exactly one negative factor and $F_{\lambda,D}(rD) < 0$. For $s > D\lceil r \rceil = D(m-1)$ every factor of $F_{\lambda,D}(s) = \prod_{q=0}^{m-1} (s - qD)$ is positive, so $F_{\lambda,D}(s) > 0$. By (55) the pivot $\pi_\lambda(s)$ is then strictly negative, which excludes every such s . At $s = D\lceil r \rceil$ the final spectral factor vanishes, so the bound is not violated there. For the lower end, $\lambda = (1)$ has $F_{\lambda,D}(rD) = rD > 0$ and $F_{\lambda,D}(s) = s < 0$ for $s < 0$. Both witnesses have degree at most $m = \lceil r \rceil + 1$, so both are admitted at every degree $M \geq \lceil r \rceil + 1$, and the finite-degree bound follows; intersecting over M gives the all-degree bound. $\square$

The bound is attained, and for the same cellwise reason. The whole ladder up to and including the cap survives at every degree, with no hypothesis on the defect.

Proposition 9.3 — The universal retained grid

Let $r > 0$, $D > 0$, and put $k = \lceil r \rceil$. Then

$$jD \in \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d) \quad (0 \leq j \leq k). \quad (79)$$

Proof of Proposition 9.3. Fix j with $0 \leq j \leq k$ and put $s = jD$. If $\ell(\lambda) \geq j + 1$ then λ contains the cell $(j + 1, 1)$, whose spectral factor is $jD - jD = 0$; hence $F_{\lambda,D}(s) = 0$ and $\pi_\lambda(s) = 0$. If $\ell(\lambda) \leq j$ then every cell (i, j') of λ has $i \leq j$, so its spectral factor satisfies $s - (i - 1)D + (j' - 1) \geq jD - (j - 1)D = D > 0$, and its rank factor $D(r - i + 1) + (j' - 1)$ is positive as well, since $i \leq j \leq k$ gives $r - i + 1 \geq r - j + 1 \geq r - k + 1 > 0$. Both factors of (55) are then positive, so $\pi_\lambda(s) > 0$. Either way $\pi_\lambda(jD) \geq 0$, and the argument is cellwise, hence valid at every degree. $\square$

Combining Proposition 9.3 with Proposition 9.2: for nonintegral $r > 0$ the locus lies in $[0, D\lceil r \rceil]$ and contains that right endpoint, so

$$\max \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d) = D\lceil r \rceil \quad (80)$$

for every $d > 0$. At integral defect the same value is visible in the closed form (104), whose largest element is $rD + \nu = D\lceil r \rceil$: the isolated point $\ell = \nu$ when $\nu \geq 2$, the band top $rD + 1$ when $\nu = 1$.

9.2 SPECTRAL AND RANK ROOTS ACCOUNT FOR EVERY NULL MODE

The boundary structure is equally explicit. By (58) the factor $s - (i - 1)d/2 + (j - 1)$ vanishes when $s = (i - 1)d/2 - k$ with $0 \leq k \leq \lambda_i - 1$, so:

Lemma 9.4 (Spectral nulls). Fix s . The monic Jack modes that the spectral factor of (55) annihilates are exactly

$$\{\lambda : F_{\lambda,D}(s) = 0\} = \bigcup_{\substack{i \geq 1 \\ k_i := (i-1)D - s \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}}} \{\lambda : \lambda_i \geq k_i + 1\}, \quad (81)$$

the union running over every row index i for which the associated k_i is a nonnegative integer. The nullspace of the pairing at s is spanned by the null basis modes

$$\{\lambda : F_{\lambda,D}(rD) = 0 \text{ or } F_{\lambda,D}(s) = 0\}, \quad (82)$$

the first alternative being the rank-null ideal of Lemma 9.5 below, which is null at every s . Each null basis mode is a single monic Jack polynomial; arbitrary linear combinations of null basis modes are again null vectors.

A single-cell reading of (81) is not correct, for two reasons. A given numerical value of s may admit several representations $s = (i - 1)D - k$, and the union is over all of them: at $(3/2, 2)$, so $D = 1$, the point $s = 0$ is both $(3 - 1)D - 2$ and $(1 - 1)D - 0$, and the mode $\lambda = (1)$ is spectrally null there through the cell $(1, 1)$ although $\lambda_3 \geq 3$ fails. Conversely a mode may be null for the rank reason rather than the spectral one: at $(3/2, 8)$ the mode $\lambda = (3, 3, 3)$ is null at $s = 12$ because it contains the rank-null cell $(3, 3)$, even though $F_{\lambda,4}(12) = 188697600 \neq 0$ and the representation $s = (4 - 1)D - 0$ would demand $\lambda_4 \geq 1$. Only the union (81) together with the ideal describes the nullspace, which is why (82) carries both alternatives.

The spectral lattice continues past the classical rank: at $(3/2, 8)$ there are spectral nulls at $s = 12, 16, 20$, contributed by rows $i = 4, 5, 6$ and so supported on partitions of those lengths. At $(3/2, 8)$ and $N = 6$ the only row contributing at $s = 7$ is $i = 3$, with $k_3 = 1$, so a spectral null there requires $\lambda_3 \geq 2$; the only such partition of size at most 6 is $\lambda = (2, 2, 2)$, and it is not in the rank-null ideal, which needs $\lambda_3 \geq 3$.

The rank factor supplies the complementary phenomenon: some partitions are annihilated identically, at every s .

Lemma 9.5 (Rank-null partitions). $\Pi_\lambda(r) = 0$ if and only if λ contains a cell (i, j) with

$$r + 1 - i + \alpha(j - 1) = 0. \quad (83)$$

The partitions containing such a cell form an ideal in the containment order, and they drop out of the pairing at every s .

In the defect variable (75) the condition (83) on the first sub-diagonal row $i = [r] + 1$ (that is $t = 0$) reads $j - 1 = \nu$, so an ideal cell on the first sub-diagonal exists precisely when the defect is a positive integer:

$$\nu \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0} \implies \text{ideal cell } ([r] + 1, \nu + 1). \quad (84)$$

At integer rank $\nu = 0$ and the cell is $([r] + 1, 1)$, recovering the familiar length ideal $\lambda_{[r]+1} \geq 1$, equivalently $\ell(\lambda) > [r]$, used in Theorem 8.5.

9.3 THE CELL LATTICE GENERATES A PRINCIPAL RANK-NULL IDEAL

The first sub-diagonal is not the whole story, and the content set settles the rest of it exactly. By (55) a cell (i, j) is rank-null precisely when $rD = (i - 1)D - (j - 1)$, so the question is whether the rescaled rank meets Λ_D , and if it does, which cells realize it.

Proposition 9.6 — The content set generates a principal rank-null ideal

Let $D > 0$ and $r \in \mathbb{R}$. A rank-null cell exists if and only if $rD \in \Lambda_D$; for $D = a/b$ in lowest terms this says $ar \in \mathbb{Z}$, and for irrational D at most one such cell can exist. If none exists, no partition is rank-null. If one exists, let (i_0, j_0) be the coordinatewise minimal solution of

$$rD = (i_0 - 1)D - (j_0 - 1), \quad i_0, j_0 \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}. \quad (85)$$

For rational $D = a/b$ the rank-null cells are then exactly

$$(i_0 + tb, j_0 + ta), \quad t \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}, \quad (86)$$

and in every case the rank-null partitions form the single principal ideal

$$\{\lambda : \Pi_\lambda(r) = 0\} = \{\lambda : \lambda_{i_0} \geq j_0\}, \quad (87)$$

generated by the rectangle $(j_0^{i_0})$ and therefore first active at degree $i_0 j_0$.

Proof of Proposition 9.6. Writing $p = i - 1$ and $q = j - 1$, the vanishing condition is $pD - q = rD$ with $p, q \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, and its right-hand side runs over Λ_D as (i, j) runs over $\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}^2$; this is the existence criterion. If D is irrational then $pD - q = p'D - q'$ forces $p = p'$ and $q = q'$, so a solution is unique. If $D = a/b$ in lowest terms the equation reads $pa - qb = ra$, so $ra \in \mathbb{Z}$ is necessary; it is sufficient because $\gcd(a, b) = 1$ makes $pa - qb = m$ solvable in integers for every $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, and replacing (p, q) by $(p + tb, q + ta)$ preserves $pa - qb$, so some shift has both coordinates nonnegative. The same shift accounts for all solutions, again by $\gcd(a, b) = 1$, and both coordinates increase with t ; hence the nonnegative solutions are the shifts by $t \geq 0$ of the coordinatewise minimal one, which is (86).

For (87), a partition with $\lambda_{i_0} \geq j_0$ contains (i_0, j_0) and is rank-null. Conversely, if λ contains a rank-null cell $(i_0 + tb, j_0 + ta)$ with $t \geq 0$ then $\lambda_{i_0} \geq \lambda_{i_0 + tb} \geq j_0 + ta \geq j_0$, since λ is nonincreasing; in the irrational case $t = 0$ is the only option and the implication is immediate. The ideal is therefore generated by the single rectangle $(j_0^{i_0})$. $\square$

In the defect variable the existence criterion and the minimal cell take a form that makes the later-row case routine. Writing $D = a/b$ in lowest terms and $k = \lceil r \rceil$, one has $ar = ak - bv$, so Proposition 9.6 becomes a statement about bv .

Corollary 9.7 (Defect form of the rank-null criterion). Let $r > 0$, let $D = a/b$ in lowest terms, put $k = \lceil r \rceil$ and $v = D(k - r)$. A rank-null cell exists if and only if $bv \in \mathbb{Z}$, giving the trichotomy

- (i) $bv \notin \mathbb{Z}$: no rank-null ideal, at any degree or row;

- (ii) $v \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$: the minimal null cell lies in row $k + 1$, namely $(k + 1, v + 1)$;
- (iii) $bv \in \mathbb{Z}$ but $v \notin \mathbb{Z}$: the minimal null cell lies in a strictly later row.

In cases (ii) and (iii), put $m = bv \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and let $t_0 \in \{0, \dots, b - 1\}$ be the least solution of $m + at_0 \equiv 0 \pmod{b}$. Then the minimal rank-null cell is

$$\left(k + 1 + t_0, 1 + \frac{m + at_0}{b}\right), \quad (88)$$

and the rank-null partitions form the principal ideal it generates.

Proof of Corollary 9.7. From $rD = kD - v$ and $D = a/b$, $ar = ak - bv$, so $ar \in \mathbb{Z}$ if and only if $bv \in \mathbb{Z}$; this is the existence criterion of Proposition 9.6. When $v \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ the cell $(k + 1, v + 1)$ is rank-null by (84) and is minimal, giving (ii); at $v = 0$ this is the integer-rank length ideal generated by $(k + 1, 1)$, with $k = r$, and (88) returns it because $m = t_0 = 0$; when $bv \in \mathbb{Z}$ but $v \notin \mathbb{Z}$ no first-row cell $(k + 1, v + 1)$ is integral, so the minimal cell has $t_0 \geq 1$, giving (iii). For (88), the rank-null condition $(i - 1)D - (j - 1) = rD$ with $i = k + 1 + t$ reads $tD - (j - 1) = -v$, i.e. $b(j - 1) = m + at$; the least $t \geq 0$ making the right side divisible by b is t_0 , and then $j - 1 = (m + at_0)/b$. Minimality and the principal-ideal statement are Proposition 9.6. $\square$

The scattered examples now read off (88) uniformly. At $(3/2, 8)$, $D = 4$ so $a = 4, b = 1$ and $bv = 2$: case (ii), minimal cell $(3, 3)$, ideal $\lambda_3 \geq 3$ generated by $(3, 3, 3)$, first active at $N = 9$. At $(5/2, 8)$, $bv = 2$ again, minimal cell $(4, 3)$. At $(2/3, 3)$, $D = 3/2$ so $a = 3, b = 2$ and $v = 1/2$, $bv = 1 \in \mathbb{Z}$ while $v \notin \mathbb{Z}$: case (iii), $t_0 = 1$, minimal cell $(3, 3)$ on the second sub-diagonal. By contrast $(3/2, 2)$, $(3/2, 6)$, $(3/2, 10)$ and $(3/2, 3)$ give $bv = 1/2, 3/2, 5/2, 3/2$, none integral: case (i), no rank-null partition at any degree or row.

9.4 DEFECT ARITHMETIC DECIDES WHETHER THE UPPER EDGE ERODES

Upper-edge erosion is governed by the lattice of cells below row $[r]$. Rectangular partitions often provide the first witness, but no single cell controls the general case.

Lemma 9.8 (Upper-edge sign rule). Let $r > 0$ be real with $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, put $k = [r]$, and write $s = kD - \varepsilon$. For a cell $c = (i, j)$ with $i = k + 1 + t$, $t \geq 0$, set $u(c) = j - 1 - tD$; then the rank factor of c is $(u(c) - v)/D$ and its spectral factor is $u(c) - \varepsilon$. For $0 < \varepsilon < D$, cells in rows $i \leq k$ contribute positive factors to both.

Fix a partition λ , and suppose in addition that ε is smaller than every positive value $u(c)$ occurring in λ . Then, uniformly over the cells of that diagram, c contributes a sign disagreement exactly when

$$0 < j - 1 - tD < v, \quad (89)$$

and c is rank-null exactly when $j - 1 - tD = v$.

Proof of Lemma 9.8. The rank factor is $((j - 1) - v - tD)/D = (u(c) - v)/D$ by (75), and the spectral factor is $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1) = u(c) - \varepsilon$. For a cell in a row $i \leq k$ both factors are positive once $\varepsilon < D$: the smallest spectral factor is that of $(k, 1)$, namely $D - \varepsilon$, and the rank factors are those of Theorem 9.1. Take ε smaller than D and then every positive value $u(c)$ occurring in λ

— finitely many conditions, so some $\varepsilon > 0$ meets them all, and one such ε serves every cell of λ at once. Then $\text{sign}(u(c) - \varepsilon) = \text{sign}(u(c))$ whenever $u(c) \neq 0$, while $u(c) = 0$ makes both factors negative. The signs of $u(c) - \nu$ and $u(c)$ differ precisely when $0 < u(c) < \nu$. $\square$

Theorem 9.9 — A lattice-gap criterion protecting the upper edge

Let $r > 0$ be real with $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, put $k = \lceil r \rceil$, and suppose

$$(tD, tD + \nu) \cap \mathbb{Z} = \emptyset \quad \text{for every } t \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}. \quad (90)$$

Then, for every cutoff N ,

$$[rD, kD] \subseteq \mathcal{W}_N(r, d), \quad (91)$$

and consequently

$$[rD, kD] \subseteq \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d). \quad (92)$$

Every pivot is nonnegative throughout $rD \leq s \leq kD$, and every pivot outside the rank-null ideal is strictly positive for $rD < s < kD$. If $D = a/b$ in lowest terms, then (90) holds if and only if

$$\nu \leq \frac{1}{b}, \quad (93)$$

and if D is irrational then (90) fails for every $\nu > 0$. In particular, for $D \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, equivalently $d \in 2\mathbb{Z}_{>0}$:

- (i) if $\nu < 1$ the upper half-band is strictly positive away from the rank-null ideal;
- (ii) if $\nu = 1$ the critical rectangle (2^{k+1}) lies in the rank-null ideal and the upper edge remains stable;
- (iii) if $\nu > 1$ the upper edge erodes, (2^{k+1}) giving a negative pivot immediately below $s = kD$.

Proof of Theorem 9.9. Write $s = kD - \varepsilon$ with $0 \leq \varepsilon \leq \nu$, which is exactly the range $rD \leq s \leq kD$. For a cell in a row $i \leq k$ the rank factor is positive, its least value being $r - k + 1 = 1 - \nu/D > 0$ at $(k, 1)$, and its spectral factor is positive as well, since $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1) \geq s - (k - 1)D = D - \varepsilon \geq D - \nu > 0$.

For a cell in row $i = k + 1 + t$ with $t \geq 0$ put $u = j - 1 - tD$, so by Lemma 9.8 the rank factor is $(u - \nu)/D$ and the spectral factor is $u - \varepsilon$. Condition (90) says precisely that no attainable u lies in the open interval $(0, \nu)$, so either $u \leq 0$ or $u \geq \nu$. If $u \leq 0$ then $u - \nu < 0$ and $u - \varepsilon \leq 0$; if $u \geq \nu$ then $u - \nu \geq 0$ and $u - \varepsilon \geq u - \nu \geq 0$. In both cases the two factors carry the same weak sign, so every pivot is nonnegative on $[rD, kD]$. For $0 < \varepsilon < \nu$ a vanishing factor requires $u = \nu$, which is the rank-null condition, so every pivot outside the rank-null ideal is strictly positive on the open interval.

For (93), write $D = a/b$ in lowest terms. The fractional parts of tD run through $0, 1/b, \dots, \frac{b-1}{b}$, so the least positive distance from a point tD up to the next integer is $1/b$. Since the interval in (90) is open, it avoids $\mathbb{Z}$ for every t exactly when $\nu \leq 1/b$. If D is irrational the fractional parts of tD are dense modulo 1, so those distances are arbitrarily small and (90) fails for every $\nu > 0$.

Finally let $D \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, so $b = 1$ and stability holds exactly when $\nu \leq 1$. If $\nu = 1$ the cell $(k + 1, 2)$ has $u = 1 = \nu$ and is rank-null. If $\nu > 1$, take $\lambda = (2^{k+1})$. Its bottom row has normalized rank factors $-\nu/D$ and $(1 - \nu)/D$, both negative, so an even number; immediately below kD its spectral factors are $-\varepsilon$ and $1 - \varepsilon$, exactly one negative. All cells in the first k rows contribute positively, so $\pi_\lambda(kD - \varepsilon) < 0$ for all small $\varepsilon > 0$. $\square$

Condition (90) is sufficient but not necessary. The sign rule of Lemma 9.8 decides the question exactly, and it is worth stating separately, because the erosion census of the next subsection is read against it rather than against (90).

Proposition 9.10 — Exact upper-edge erosion criterion

Let $r > 0$ be real with $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, put $k = \lceil r \rceil$, and set

$$\mathcal{M} = \{(k + 1 + t, j) : 0 < j - 1 - tD < \nu\}, \quad \mathcal{Z} = \{(k + 1 + t, j) : j - 1 - tD = \nu\}. \quad (94)$$

For a fixed λ and all sufficiently small $\varepsilon > 0$: if $\lambda \cap \mathcal{Z} \neq \emptyset$ then $\pi_\lambda(kD - \varepsilon) = 0$, and if $\lambda \cap \mathcal{Z} = \emptyset$ then $\text{sign } \pi_\lambda(kD - \varepsilon) = (-1)^{|\lambda \cap \mathcal{M}|}$. Consequently the upper edge erodes if and only if some finite diagram λ satisfies

$$\lambda \cap \mathcal{Z} = \emptyset \quad \text{and} \quad |\lambda \cap \mathcal{M}| \equiv 1 \pmod{2}. \quad (95)$$

Proof of Proposition 9.10. By Lemma 9.8 a cell c of λ contributes a sign disagreement exactly when $c \in \mathcal{M}$, and contributes a vanishing rank factor exactly when $c \in \mathcal{Z}$; all other cells contribute agreeing nonzero signs. A product is zero as soon as one factor is, and otherwise its sign is the parity of the number of disagreements, which is (95). The upper edge erodes precisely when some pivot is strictly negative immediately below kD . $\square$

Condition (90) is the special case $\mathcal{M} = \emptyset$, and the integer-step trichotomy above is the corollary of Proposition 9.10 at $b = 1$. The gap between the two is real: at $r = 4/3$, $d = 3$ one has $D = 3/2$ and $\nu = 1$, so $\mathcal{M} \neq \emptyset$ and (90) fails, yet every diagram reaching a cell of $\mathcal{M}$ also meets $\mathcal{Z}$ and is annihilated, so the edge does not erode.

The hypothesis $D \in \mathbb{Z}$ in the second half is not decorative. When D is not an integer the lattice condition (90) can fail at some $t \geq 1$ even though $\nu < 1$, and then the upper edge erodes at a degree well above $2(k + 1)$.

9.5 THE CENSUS REVEALS PROTECTED, ONE-SIDED, AND TWO-SIDED EROSION

With the mechanism in hand the computed loci can be read as a census. Three examples separate the possibilities — a small defect that fails to protect the edge, erosion from below, and an ideal that halts erosion after one step — and the figure and table then display the whole phenomenology at once.

Remark 9.1 (A small defect does not protect the upper edge). Take $r = 3/2$ and $d = 3$, so $D = 3/2$, $k = 2$ and $v = 3/4 < 1$. Condition (90) holds at $t = 0$, but at $t = 1$ the interval $(3/2, 9/4)$ contains the integer 2, and the cell with $t = 1$, $j = 3$ has $u = 1/2 \in (0, v)$. The rectangle $\lambda = (3, 3, 3, 3)$ realizes exactly one such cell. Its rank factor $F_{\lambda, 3/2}(9/4)$ is a positive rational (the exact value is in the ancillary data), while its spectral factor $F_{\lambda, 3/2}(s)$ is negative for $5/2 < s < 3$, so $\pi_\lambda(s) < 0$ there. The upper edge therefore erodes at degree 12: the locus is $\{0, 3/2\} \cup [2, 3]$ at $N = 6$ and $\{0, 3/2\} \cup [2, 5/2] \cup \{3\}$ at $N = 12$. Every fractional row of Table 1 and Figure 3 has d even, hence $D \in \mathbb{Z}$, so those rows are governed by the trichotomy above; the phenomenon here is invisible at even d .

The threshold is not monotone in d : at $v = 1$ the cell that would produce a negative pivot is the same cell that annihilates the partition, so $v = 1$ is protected for a different reason than $v < 1$. And the governing quantity is the defect together with the arithmetic of D , not the multiplicity by itself: at $(6/5, 3)$, where $v = 6/5 > 1$, the upper edge erodes although $d < 4$, while at $(3/4, 8)$, where $v = 1$, it does not although $d > 4$.

Theorem 9.9 concerns the upper edge alone. It does not assert that the band is stable, and in general the band can also erode from below. The exact witness is

$$r = \frac{3}{2}, \quad d = 3, \quad v = \frac{3}{4}, \quad s = \frac{13}{8}, \quad \lambda = (2, 2, 2), \quad (96)$$

for which $F_{\lambda, D}(rD) < 0$ and $F_{\lambda, D}(s) > 0$, so the pivot is strictly negative at a point interior to the band $[3/2, 3]$ predicted by Theorem 9.1, near its lower endpoint. The computed locus changes from $\{0\} \cup [3/2, 3]$ at $N = 5$ to $\{0, 3/2\} \cup [2, 3]$ at $N = 6$: the lower endpoint has increased while the upper endpoint is intact. Statements about stability of the whole band therefore require a separate argument, such as Theorem 10.1 at $d = 2$.

At $(3/2, 8)$ the critical rectangle is $\lambda = (2, 2, 2)$, with $\text{sign } \Pi_\lambda(3/2) = +1$ and

$$(s)_{(2,2,2)}^{(1/4)} = s(s+1)(s-3)(s-4)(s-7)(s-8), \quad (97)$$

a sextic that is negative on $(-1, 0) \cup (3, 4) \cup (7, 8)$ and, within the band $[4, 8]$, negative exactly on the open cell $(7, 8)$. At cutoff $N = 6$ the Gram form has inertia 29 positive and 1 negative throughout $7 < s < 8$. At $s = 7$ and cutoff $N = 6$ the unique null mode is $P_{(2,2,2)}$; the band's upper boundary drops from 8 to 7, and $s = 8$ survives in isolation. Every deeper erosion candidate at $(3/2, 8)$ — the Pochhammer zeros at $s = 6$ and $s = 5$ inside the band — requires $\lambda_3 \geq 3$ and therefore lies in the rank-null ideal. This is the cellwise argument behind the stability observed below; it is the ideal, not the size of the cutoff, that ends the erosion.

Table 1 records the exact loci. Each entry is an algebraic cell decomposition in exact rational arithmetic at the stated cutoff.

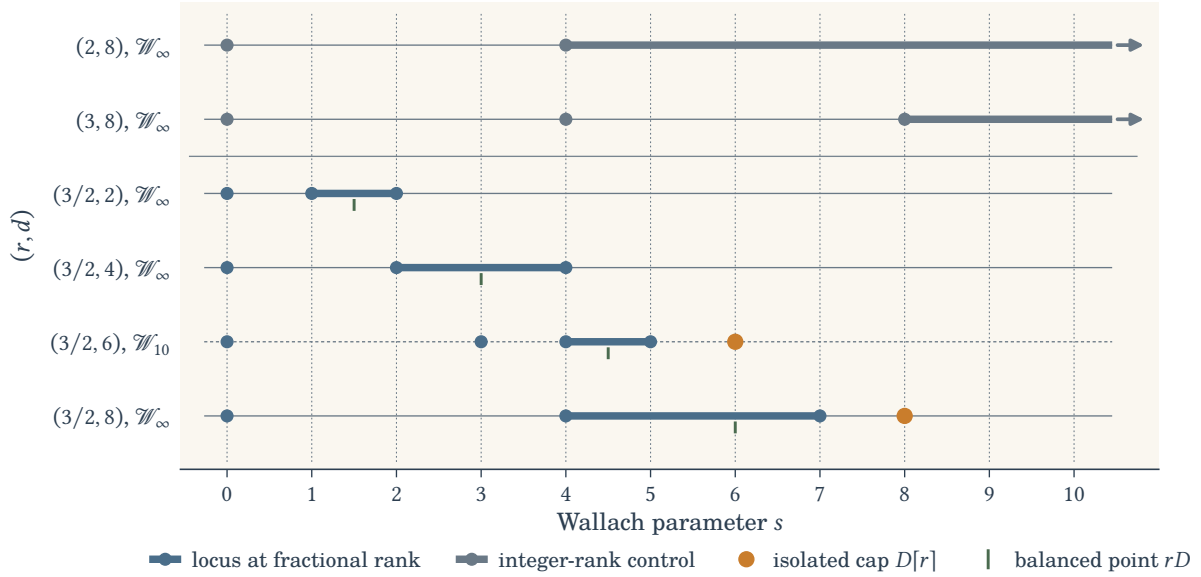


Figure 3. Positivity at integer and fractional rank; each row is labelled with the locus it shows, and the one finite-cutoff row carries a dashed rule. The grey integer controls ($r = 2, 3$), governed by Theorem 8.5, carry the classical ladder and an unbounded ray. Every fractional row has $r = 3/2$, and its ray is replaced by a bounded band whose erosion is decided by the defect $v = d/4$: none at $d = 2, 4$, one step at $d = 8$ before the rank-null ideal halts it, two-sided at $d = 6$, where no ideal exists. An amber mark is an isolated cap point $D[r]$, retained at every degree by Proposition 9.3 and maximal in its locus by (80); the short rule beneath each fractional row is the balanced point rD of (72), which every band contains. All loci are exact. Every fractional row has d even, so Theorem 9.9(i)–(iii) applies; see Remark 9.1 for odd d .

Table 1. *Exact positivity loci at selected fractional ranks. For these even multiplicities, hence $D \in \mathbb{Z}$, the integer-step trichotomy of Theorem 9.9 applies and erosion is governed by the defect $\nu = D(\lceil r \rceil - r)$, not by d : the rows with $\nu \leq 1$ never move, the two rows with $\nu = 2$ erode once and are then stopped by the rank-null ideal, and $(3/2, 6)$, whose $\nu = 3/2$ admits no ideal, erodes twice — at $N = 6$ and again at $N = 9$.*

(r, d)	$N = 4$	$N = 6$	$N = 8$
$(3/2, 2)$	$\{0\} \cup [1, 2]$	$\{0\} \cup [1, 2]$	$\{0\} \cup [1, 2]$
$(3/2, 4)$	$\{0\} \cup [2, 4]$	$\{0\} \cup [2, 4]$	$\{0\} \cup [2, 4]$
$(3/2, 6)$	$\{0\} \cup [3, 6]$	$\{0\} \cup [3, 5] \cup \{6\}$	$\{0\} \cup [3, 5] \cup \{6\}$
$(3/2, 8)$	$\{0\} \cup [4, 8]$	$\{0\} \cup [4, 7] \cup \{8\}$	$\{0\} \cup [4, 7] \cup \{8\}$
$(5/2, 8)$	$\{0, 4\} \cup [8, 12]$	$\{0, 4\} \cup [8, 12]$	$\{0, 4\} \cup [8, 11] \cup \{12\}$

(r, d)	$N = 9$	$N = 10$
$(3/2, 2)$	$\{0\} \cup [1, 2]$	$\{0\} \cup [1, 2]$
$(3/2, 4)$	$\{0\} \cup [2, 4]$	$\{0\} \cup [2, 4]$
$(3/2, 6)$	$\{0\} \cup \{3\} \cup [4, 5] \cup \{6\}$	$\{0\} \cup \{3\} \cup [4, 5] \cup \{6\}$
$(3/2, 8)$	$\{0\} \cup [4, 7] \cup \{8\}$	$\{0\} \cup [4, 7] \cup \{8\}$
$(5/2, 8)$	$\{0, 4\} \cup [8, 11] \cup \{12\}$	$\{0, 4\} \cup [8, 11] \cup \{12\}$

10 ARITHMETIC CONTROLS THE SURVIVING LOCUS AND ITS STABILIZATION

Arithmetic now separates three regimes, and it is worth having the whole map before the casework begins. Write $D = a/b$ in lowest terms and $\nu = D(\lceil r \rceil - r)$. Corollary 9.7 sorts every positive rank into exactly one of three classes according to the arithmetic of $b\nu$, and the class determines both which rank-null ideal exists and which stabilization mechanism is available.

CONDITION	RANK-NULL IDEAL	KNOWN STABILIZATION MECHANISM
$b\nu \notin \mathbb{Z}$	none, at any row	finite rational sign stratification
$b\nu \in \mathbb{Z}, \nu \notin \mathbb{Z}$	later-row principal ideal	ideal together with finite stratification
$\nu \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$	first-subdiagonal ideal	exact falling-factorial staircase

Table 2. *The arithmetic regimes at positive nonintegral rank, and what is known in each. The three conditions are exhaustive and mutually exclusive. Effectivity is available only in the third row and in the unit-numerator case $a = 1$ of the first; Theorem 10.8 supplies stabilization without a threshold throughout.*

When the numerator of D is one, the cell chamber fills the whole initial band and no erosion occurs, so the locus can be written down completely. At integral defect the surviving locus

follows an exact falling-factorial staircase and stabilizes at a computable degree. Outside these two regimes the band may fragment; stabilization still occurs at every rational step, but no uniform stable-locus formula is presently known.

10.1 UNIT-NUMERATOR STEPS PREVENT EROSION

At $d = 2$ the content set is $\mathbb{Z}$, the chamber containing $rD = r$ is $[\lfloor r \rfloor, \lfloor r \rfloor + 1]$, and the whole locus can be written down at every positive nonintegral rank.

Theorem 10.1 — Unit cell step prevents erosion

Let $r > 0$ be nonintegral and write $m = \lfloor r \rfloor$. Then

$$\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, 2) = \{0, 1, \dots, m-1\} \cup [m, m+1], \quad (98)$$

the finite set being empty when $m = 0$, and the pairing is positive definite throughout $m < s < m+1$.

Proof of Theorem 10.1. Here $D = 1$, so a cell (i, j) contributes $r + j - i$ to the rank factor and $s + j - i$ to the spectral factor; both depend on the cell only through the integer $m' = j - i$.

If $m < s < m+1$ then r and s lie in the same component of $\mathbb{R} \setminus \mathbb{Z}$, so for every integer m' the numbers $r + m'$ and $s + m'$ do too, and in particular share a nonzero sign. By (59) every pivot is strictly positive, and the argument is cellwise, hence independent of the degree. This is Theorem 8.4 for $\Lambda_1 = \mathbb{Z}$. At the endpoints $s = m$ and $s = m+1$ the same comparison gives weakly matching signs, with spectral zeros permitted, so the closed band lies in $\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, 2)$.

The ladder points $0, 1, \dots, m-1$ are retained exactly as in Theorem 8.5: at $s = j < m$ a partition with at most j rows has strictly positive spectral factors, and one with more contains the cell $(j+1, 1)$, whose spectral factor vanishes. The gaps $(j, j+1)$ with $0 \leq j \leq m-1$ are excluded by the column (1^{j+2}) , which has exactly one negative spectral factor and no negative rank factor; $s < 0$ is excluded by the one-box partition $\lambda = (1)$; and $s > m+1$ is excluded by Proposition 9.2, whose witness is the column (1^{m+2}) . These exhaust $\mathbb{R}$. $\square$

The same argument runs verbatim whenever the initial band is a single cell chamber, which happens exactly when D has numerator 1.

Corollary 10.2 — Unit-numerator steps

Let $b \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ and $d = 2/b$, so $D = 1/b$. Then for every positive nonintegral r ,

$$\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, 2/b) = \left\{ \frac{j}{b} : 0 \leq j < \lfloor r \rfloor \right\} \cup \left[\frac{\lfloor r \rfloor}{b}, \frac{\lfloor r \rfloor}{b} \right]. \quad (99)$$

Proof of Corollary 10.2. With $D = 1/b$ in lowest terms, $\Lambda_D = b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ by Theorem 8.4, and $rD = r/b$ lies in the interior of the chamber $[\lfloor r \rfloor/b, \lfloor r \rfloor/b]$ because r is not an integer. That chamber is

exactly the initial band $[r]D, [r]D]$ of Theorem 9.1, so Theorem 8.4 places all of it in $\mathcal{W}_\infty$, at every degree. The ladder points, the gaps below, the negative axis and the region above $[r]D$ are handled exactly as in Theorem 10.1 and Proposition 9.2. $\square$

Thus $N_{\text{er}} = \infty$ whenever the numerator of D is 1, and no erosion occurs at any degree. Erosion is possible only when the initial band strictly contains a cell chamber: among rational steps, exactly when D has numerator at least 2. For irrational D the content set is dense and no nondegenerate chamber exists at all.

10.2 INTEGRAL DEFECT LEAVES ONE INTERVAL AND FINITELY MANY ISOLATED POINTS

When the defect is a positive integer, the entire integral-defect classification — the exact locus at each cutoff, the all-degree locus, the stabilization degree, and every erosion event — follows from one one-dimensional identity. On the terminal chamber the pivot is a product of two falling factorials, and the whole sign analysis reduces to reading their signs.

Throughout this subsection $k = [r]$ and $v = D(k - r) \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, so $0 < v < D$ and $rD = kD - v$; by (84) the rank-null ideal is $\lambda_{k+1} \geq v + 1$. Write $x^m = x(x - 1) \cdots (x - m + 1)$ for the falling factorial, with the empty product read as 1.

Lemma 10.3 (Terminal falling-factorial reduction). Let λ lie outside the rank-null ideal, put $m = \lambda_{k+1} \leq v$, and write $s = kD - \sigma$ with $0 \leq \sigma \leq D$. Then

$$\pi_\lambda(kD - \sigma) = C_\lambda(\sigma) v^m \sigma^m, \quad (100)$$

where $C_\lambda(\sigma) > 0$ for $0 \leq \sigma < D$ and $C_\lambda(D) \geq 0$. Consequently, on the interior $0 \leq \sigma < D$ the sign of the pivot is exactly the sign of σ^m .

Proof of Lemma 10.3. By (55) the pivot is $D^{-|\lambda|} H_\lambda(D)^{-1}$ times the product over cells of the rank factor $D(r - i + 1) + (j - 1)$ and the spectral factor $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1)$; the scalar is positive, so it is absorbed into C_λ and we track the two cell products. For a cell in a row $i \leq k$ both factors are positive when $0 \leq \sigma < D$: their least values are $r - k + 1 = 1 - v/D > 0$ and $s - (k - 1)D = D - \sigma > 0$. At $\sigma = D$ the spectral factors are still nonnegative.

For a cell in row $i = k + 1 + t$ write $q = j - 1$. The rank factor is $q - v - tD$ and the spectral factor is $q - \sigma - tD$. Because λ lies outside the ideal, $q \leq \lambda_{k+1} - 1 = m - 1 \leq v - 1$. For $t \geq 1$ both factors are strictly negative, since $q \leq v - 1 < v \leq tD \leq \sigma + tD$ and $q < v < D \leq tD$; their product is positive and contributes to C_λ . The remaining cells, in row $t = 0$, contribute

$$\prod_{q=0}^{m-1} (q - v)(q - \sigma) = \prod_{q=0}^{m-1} (v - q)(\sigma - q) = v^m \sigma^m.$$

Collecting, $\pi_\lambda(kD - \sigma) = C_\lambda(\sigma) v^m \sigma^m$ with C_λ a product of positive factors for $0 \leq \sigma < D$, hence positive there, and nonnegative at $\sigma = D$. Since $v^m > 0$ for $m \leq v$, the interior sign is that of σ^m . $\square$

The one-dimensional problem is now transparent. At cutoff N the terminal chamber is tested by exactly those falling factorials σ^m whose rectangle (m^{k+1}) fits, that is $1 \leq m \leq M_N$. Their common nonnegativity set is an elementary interval-plus-points, and the statement involves no parameter of the pairing: the mechanism is simply that a nonintegral $\sigma \geq 0$ has its first negative falling factorial at order $\lfloor \sigma \rfloor + 2$, while an integral $\sigma \geq 0$ reaches zero there instead and stays zero.

Lemma 10.4 (Common nonnegativity of initial falling factorials). For every integer $M \geq 1$,

$$\{\sigma \in \mathbb{R} : \sigma^m \geq 0 \text{ for every } 1 \leq m \leq M\} = \{0, 1, \dots, M-2\} \cup [M-1, \infty), \quad (101)$$

the finite set being empty when $M = 1$.

Proof of Lemma 10.4. If $\sigma \geq M-1$ then $\sigma \geq m-1$ for every $m \leq M$, so every factor of $\sigma^m = \sigma(\sigma-1)\cdots(\sigma-m+1)$ is nonnegative. If $\sigma = n \in \{0, \dots, M-2\}$ then σ^m is a product of positive factors for $m \leq n$ and vanishes for every $m \geq n+1$. Every remaining σ is either negative, in which case $\sigma^1 < 0$, or satisfies $n < \sigma < n+1$ for some $0 \leq n \leq M-2$, in which case σ^{n+2} has exactly one negative factor, namely $\sigma - (n+1)$, and $n+2 \leq M$, so the offending constraint is present. $\square$

Theorem 10.5 — The exact finite-cutoff erosion staircase

Let $r > 0$, $r \notin \mathbb{Z}$, with $v = D(\lceil r \rceil - r) \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, put $k = \lceil r \rceil$, and for $N \geq k+1$ set

$$M_N = \min\left(v, \left\lfloor \frac{N}{k+1} \right\rfloor\right). \quad (102)$$

Then the exact cutoff- N positivity locus is

$$\mathcal{W}_N(r, d) = \{jD : 0 \leq j \leq k-2\} \cup [(k-1)D, kD - M_N + 1] \cup \{kD - j : 0 \leq j \leq M_N - 2\}, \quad (103)$$

the first set empty when $k = 1$ and the last empty when $M_N = 1$.

Proof of Theorem 10.5. A partition with $\lambda_{k+1} = m$ has $|\lambda| \geq m(k+1)$, with equality for the rectangle (m^{k+1}) ; so at cutoff N the admissible terminal indices are exactly $0 \leq m \leq M_N$, and every such m is realized by an admissible rectangle. On the terminal chamber $kD - D \leq s \leq kD$, write $s = kD - \sigma$ with $0 \leq \sigma \leq D$. By Lemma 10.3 a partition outside the ideal with $\lambda_{k+1} = m$ has $\text{sign } \pi_\lambda(kD - \sigma) = \text{sign } \sigma^m$ on the interior, and partitions inside the ideal are rank-null, contributing a zero pivot. The terminal chamber therefore lies in $\mathcal{W}_N$ at σ precisely when $\sigma^m \geq 0$ for every $1 \leq m \leq M_N$. Since $M_N \leq v < D$, all of $\{0, \dots, M_N-2\}$ and the endpoint M_N-1 lie in $[0, D]$, so intersecting (101) with the terminal chamber $0 \leq \sigma \leq D$ gives $\sigma \in [M_N-1, D] \cup \{0, \dots, M_N-2\}$. Mapping back through $s = kD - \sigma$ turns $[M_N-1, D]$ into the interval $[(k-1)D, kD - M_N + 1]$ and the point set into $\{kD - j : 0 \leq j \leq M_N - 2\}$; the endpoint $\sigma = D$, i.e. $s = (k-1)D$, is retained because there every $C_\lambda(D) \geq 0$ and $\sigma^m \geq 0$.

Outside the terminal chamber the locus is N -independent above $k+1$ and matches the retained ladder and its gaps. The ladder points jD for $0 \leq j \leq k-2$, the gaps between them, the region $s > kD$, and the interval floor $s < (k-1)D$ are all controlled by the same column

witnesses used in Theorem 8.5 and Theorem 9.1: the columns (1^{j+2}) exclude each open gap below the band, (1^{k+1}) excludes $s > kD$, and (1) excludes $s < 0$, all of degree at most $k + 1 \leq N$. This gives (103). $\square$

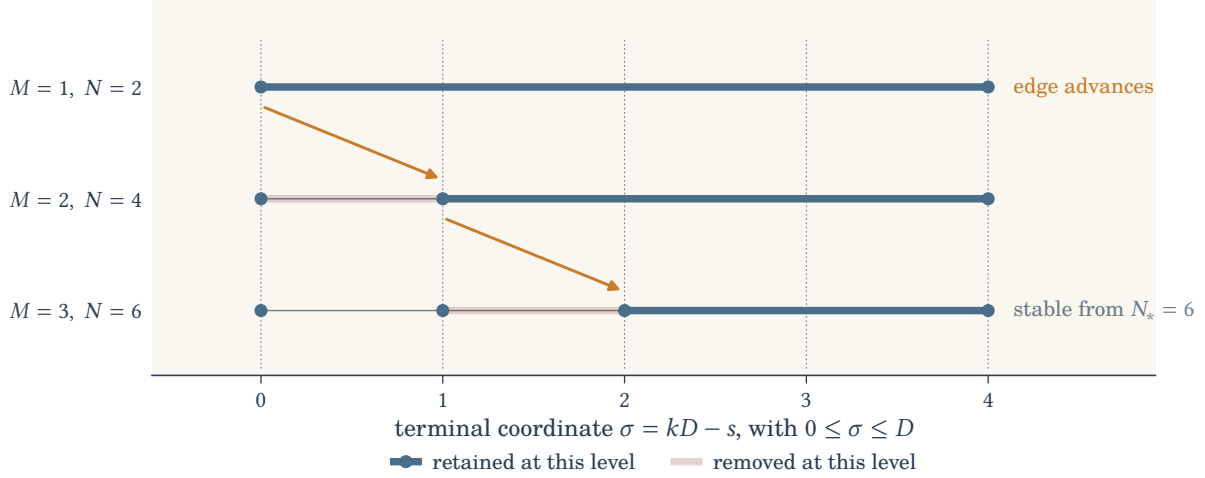


Figure 4. The integral-defect erosion staircase, drawn in the terminal coordinate $\sigma = kD - s$ alone; the spectral parameter is recovered by $s = kD - \sigma$, which reverses orientation. Each row is a constraint level $M = 1, \dots, v$, first imposed at cutoff $N = M(k + 1)$, and the levels run downward, so the bottom row is the stable one. At level M the surviving continuous interval is $[M - 1, D]$ and the isolated survivors are $\{0, \dots, M - 2\}$: the continuous endpoint advances one unit per level and leaves the vacated endpoint behind as an isolated point, and the faded segment is the open interval removed at that level. The staircase halts at $M = v$, that is at $N_* = v(k + 1)$. Drawn for the Albert step $D = 4$ at $r = 1/4$, where $k = 1$ and $v = 3$, so the levels arrive at $N = 2, 4, 6$ and $N_* = 6$. The bottom row is $\sigma \in [2, 4] \cup \{0, 1\}$, that is $s \in [0, 2] \cup \{3, 4\}$, the all-degree locus (104).

The all-degree locus and the stabilization degree are now corollaries, obtained by letting the cutoff grow until M_N saturates at v .

Corollary 10.6 (Integral defect leaves one interval and finitely many isolated points). Under the hypotheses of Theorem 10.5,

$$\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d) = \{jD : 0 \leq j < \lfloor r \rfloor\} \cup [\lfloor r \rfloor D, rD + 1] \cup \{rD + \ell : 2 \leq \ell \leq v\}, \quad (104)$$

empty pieces omitted: the retained ladder, the surviving band, and the $v - 1$ isolated spectral zeros above it.

Proof of Corollary 10.6. For $N \geq v(k + 1)$ one has $M_N = v$, so (103) is independent of N and equals $\mathcal{W}_\infty$. Substituting $M_N = v$ and $kD - v = rD$ turns $[(k - 1)D, kD - v + 1]$ into $[\lfloor r \rfloor D, rD + 1]$, since $(k - 1)D = \lfloor r \rfloor D$, and turns $\{kD - j : 0 \leq j \leq v - 2\}$ into $\{rD + \ell : 2 \leq \ell \leq v\}$ under $\ell = v - j$. The ladder $\{jD : 0 \leq j \leq k - 2\}$ is $\{jD : 0 \leq j < \lfloor r \rfloor\}$. $\square$

10.3 A CRITICAL RECTANGLE GIVES THE EXACT STABILIZATION DEGREE

Corollary 10.7 (A critical rectangle gives the exact stabilization degree). Under the same hypotheses, $\mathcal{W}_N(r, d) = \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d)$ for every $N \geq N_*$ and $\mathcal{W}_{N_*-1} \supsetneq \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d)$, where

$$N_* = \nu(k + 1). \quad (105)$$

More precisely, the level- m constraint first appears at cutoff $m(k + 1)$: when $\nu = 1$ the capped band is already stable at cutoff $k + 1$ and no subsequent band erosion occurs; when $\nu \geq 2$ the first erosion is at $N = 2(k + 1)$; and each event $2 \leq m \leq \nu$ lowers the continuous endpoint by one unit and leaves the old endpoint as an isolated point.

Proof of Corollary 10.7. By (102), M_N is nondecreasing in N , reaches ν exactly at $N = \nu(k + 1)$, and takes the value $m < \nu$ first at $N = m(k + 1)$. So (103) is constant for $N \geq N_*$ and equals $\mathcal{W}_\infty$ by Corollary 10.6.

Suppose first that $\nu = 1$, so that $N_* = k + 1$ and $N_* - 1 = k$, a cutoff below the hypothesis $N \geq k + 1$ of Theorem 10.5; the strictness is therefore argued directly. At cutoff k every admitted partition has at most k rows, so every cell lies in a row $i \leq k$. Its rank factor $D(r - i + 1) + (j - 1)$ is at least $D(r - k + 1) = D - \nu = D - 1 > 0$, since $\nu < D$ always, and its spectral factor $s - (i - 1)D + (j - 1)$ is at least $s - (k - 1)D$, hence nonnegative for $s \geq (k - 1)D$. Thus every pivot is nonnegative there and $[(k - 1)D, \infty) \subseteq \mathcal{W}_k(r, d)$, whereas by (104) $\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d) \cap [(k - 1)D, \infty) = [(k - 1)D, kD]$. So $\mathcal{W}_{N_*-1} \supsetneq \mathcal{W}_\infty$.

Now suppose $\nu \geq 2$, so $N_* - 1 = \nu(k + 1) - 1 \geq k + 1$ and Theorem 10.5 applies at that cutoff, where $M_{N_*-1} = \nu - 1$. Its continuous interval $[(k - 1)D, kD - \nu + 2]$ ends at $rD + 2$ whereas the stable interval ends at $rD + 1$, so the open unit gap $(rD + 1, rD + 2)$ lies in $\mathcal{W}_{N_*-1} \setminus \mathcal{W}_\infty$.

Finally, each increment of M_N from $m - 1$ to m replaces $[m - 2, D] \cup \{0, \dots, m - 3\}$ by $[m - 1, D] \cup \{0, \dots, m - 2\}$, lowering the continuous edge by one unit and retaining $m - 2$ as an isolated point. That is the stated erosion event. $\square$

The predicted cutoffs are attained exactly: $N_* = 6$ at $(3/2, 8)$ and at $(1/4, 8)$, $N_* = 8$ at $(5/2, 8)$, $N_* = 4$ at $(1/2, 8)$, and $N_* = 2$ at $(3/4, 8)$ and $(1/2, 4)$. For the Albert step $D = 4$ the three admissible defects give the 3 : 2 : 1 staircase of Figure 4: with $m = \lfloor r \rfloor$ and the ladder $\{0, 4, \dots, 4(m - 1)\}$ appended, the terminal locus is $[4m, 4m + 2] \cup \{4m + 3, 4m + 4\}$ at $\nu = 3$, then $[4m, 4m + 3] \cup \{4m + 4\}$ at $\nu = 2$, then the unbroken $[4m, 4m + 4]$ at $\nu = 1$. As explicit all-degree instances of (104), rather than finite-cutoff computations, the two quarter-rank classes at the Albert step give

$$\mathcal{W}_\infty\left(\frac{1}{2}, 8\right) = [0, 3] \cup \{4\}, \quad \mathcal{W}_\infty\left(\frac{1}{4}, 8\right) = [0, 2] \cup \{3, 4\}. \quad (106)$$

10.4 RATIONAL CONTENT GRIDS FORCE STABILIZATION; IRRATIONAL STEPS REMAIN OPEN

Outside the two exact regimes no closed form is available, but stabilization itself is not in doubt. It follows from two facts already established: the locus is caged in a bounded interval, and at rational step every sign change can occur only on a fixed finite lattice. A decreasing sequence of subsets of a finite stratification must terminate.

Theorem 10.8 — Rational steps stabilize

Let $d > 0$ with $D = d/2 \in \mathbb{Q}$, and let $r \in \mathbb{R}$. Then there is a finite $N_0 = N_0(r, d)$ with

$$\mathcal{W}_N(r, d) = \mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d) \quad \text{for every } N \geq N_0. \quad (107)$$

For $r > 0$ nonintegral, $\mathcal{W}_\infty(r, d)$ is a finite union of closed intervals and isolated points contained in $[0, D[r]]$, with all endpoints in $b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, where $D = a/b$ in lowest terms.

Proof of Theorem 10.8. Take first $r > 0$ nonintegral and put $k = [r]$, $D = a/b$ in lowest terms. By Proposition 9.2 and (80), together with the exclusion of $s < 0$ by the one-box partition $\lambda = (1)$, every $\mathcal{W}_N$ with $N \geq k + 1$ is contained in the bounded interval $[0, kD]$.

By (59) the only s -dependence of a pivot is the factor $F_{\lambda, D}(s)$, whose roots are the cell values $(i - 1)D - (j - 1)$. Each of these lies in $b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, since $(i - 1)a/b - (j - 1) = ((i - 1)a - (j - 1)b)/b$. Consequently every pivot has constant sign on each open interval $(m/b, \frac{m+1}{b})$, and the finitely many such intervals meeting $[0, kD]$, together with the finitely many points m/b in $[0, kD]$, form a finite stratification $\mathcal{S}$ of that interval into $2bkD + 1$ strata. Each $\mathcal{W}_N \cap [0, kD]$ is a union of members of $\mathcal{S}$: on an open stratum every pivot is of one sign, so the stratum lies in $\mathcal{W}_N$ or is disjoint from it.

Finally $\mathcal{W}_{N+1} \subseteq \mathcal{W}_N$, because $\mathcal{W}_N$ is the intersection of the nonnegativity sets of the pivots of degree at most N and the index set grows with N . A decreasing sequence of subunions of a finite stratification is eventually constant, and its eventual value is its intersection, namely $\mathcal{W}_\infty$. Its endpoints are strata boundaries, hence lie in $b^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$.

For r a positive integer, Theorem 8.5 gives $\mathcal{W}_N(r, d)$ explicitly and independently of N for $N \geq r$, so $N_0 = r$ serves. For $r = 0$, Proposition 11.2 gives $\mathcal{W}_N(0, d) = \mathbb{R}$ at every N . For $r < 0$, the pair (r, d) is the image under Theorem 11.1 of the positive pair $(-rD, 4/d)$, whose step $2/d = 1/D$ is again rational; since (109) holds cutoff by cutoff, stabilization of the positive partner at N_0 gives stabilization of (r, d) at the same N_0 . $\square$

The argument uses rationality of D only through the finiteness of the stratification, and that is exactly what fails otherwise: for irrational D the fractional parts of tD are dense modulo 1, the content set Λ_D is dense, and no finite stratification of a bounded interval refines every pivot's sign pattern. Whether finite stabilization nevertheless holds at irrational step is open.

Theorem 10.8 settles the three examples that the finite-cutoff computations above leave without a closed form. At $(3/2, 6)$, $(3/2, 10)$ and $(3/2, 3)$ the steps are $D = 3, 5, 3/2$, all rational, so

each locus is eventually constant. What is not settled for them is the stabilization degree and the closed form, and that is where the remaining work lies.

The neighbouring chamber shows what integrality of the defect buys. On the open chamber $0 < rD < 1$ the sign of every rank factor is constant, since by (55) each is affine in rD and changes sign only at a lattice point, i.e. at the chamber boundary. Hence the fixed-cutoff locus is the same for all ranks in the chamber, and the ranks $1/6, 1/8, 1/12, 1/16$ at $d = 8$ are analytically distinct but positivity-identical, with common locus $[0, 1] \cup \{2, 3, 4\}$ at cutoff $N = 12$. This is not an instance of (104): the defect there is $\nu = 4(1 - r) \in (3, 4)$, never an integer, so no rank-null ideal is available and Corollary 10.6 does not apply.

Remark 10.1 (Nonintegral defect). When $\nu \notin \mathbb{Z}$ there is no critical-row ideal, so (104) does not apply and the master pivot formula (55) remains the exact description. Two things can then happen that (104) does not capture: truncation or stabilization by a later-row rank-null ideal, at $t > 0$ with $\nu + tD \in \mathbb{Z}$, and two-sided fragmentation of the band. The case $d \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ at half-integer rank is of this kind: at $(3/2, 10)$, where $\nu = 5/2$, the locus at $N = 12$ is $\{0\} \cup \{5\} \cup [7, 8] \cup \{9\} \cup \{10\}$, which has several connected components inside the initial band — a surviving interval together with additional isolated interior points — so no single-band closed form holds. The pivot formula still locates every sign and zero, and Theorem 10.8 shows the locus does stabilize; what is missing is a uniform closed form and a threshold.

What the exact regimes add beyond Theorem 10.8 is effectivity. For the unit-numerator family Corollary 10.2 shows that no erosion occurs at any degree, so $N_0 = k + 1$; at integral defect Corollary 10.7 gives the exact threshold $N_* = \nu([r] + 1)$. Outside those two regimes Theorem 10.8 guarantees stabilization but does not determine the least stabilizing cutoff, and nonintegral defect splits further along the middle row of Table 2. If $b\nu \in \mathbb{Z}$, Corollary 9.7 supplies a later-row principal rank-null ideal, which may truncate erosion by a mechanism distinct from the critical-row staircase. If $b\nu \notin \mathbb{Z}$, no rank-null ideal exists at any row, so stabilization must come solely from the finiteness of the rational sign stratification. The examples $(3/2, 6)$, $(3/2, 10)$ and $(3/2, 3)$ all belong to this latter class. Their computed loci are stationary over the displayed cutoff ranges — $10 \leq N \leq 14$, $12 \leq N \leq 14$ and $12 \leq N \leq 14$ respectively — but those observations do not determine the least stabilizing cutoff. Determining N_0 , separately in each of the two nonintegral-defect classes, is the open problem that replaces the former question of whether stabilization occurs at all.

11 PARTITION CONJUGATION TRANSPORTS POSITIVITY ACROSS RECIPROCAL STEPS

The pairing at step d and the pairing at the reciprocal step $4/d$ are carried onto one another by conjugation of partitions. This is the positivity-side counterpart of the reciprocal-step duality of Theorem 4.3: there the symbol at step h was matched with the symbol at step $1/h$, and here, since $h = D$, the same involution $D \mapsto 1/D$ acts on the Jack pairing.

11.1 CONJUGATION SENDS d TO $4/d$

Theorem 11.1 — Partition conjugation transports the locus under $d \leftrightarrow 4/d$

Let $d > 0$ and $D = d/2$, put $d^\vee = 4/d$ so that $D^\vee = 1/D$, and write λ' for the conjugate partition. Then for every partition λ and every y ,

$$F_{\lambda', D^\vee}(-\frac{y}{D}) = \left(-\frac{1}{D}\right)^{|\lambda|} F_{\lambda, D}(y). \quad (108)$$

Consequently, setting $r^\vee = -rD$, the pivots at (r, d) and at $(r^\vee, d^\vee)$ have equal signs under $\lambda \mapsto \lambda'$ and $s \mapsto -s/D$, and therefore, at every cutoff N and hence for the all-degree locus,

$$\mathcal{W}_N(-rD, \frac{4}{d}) = -\frac{1}{D} \mathcal{W}_N(r, d). \quad (109)$$

The correspondence $(r, d) \mapsto (-rD, 4/d)$ is an involution.

Proof of Theorem 11.1. The cells of λ' are exactly the pairs (j, i) with $(i, j) \in \lambda$. The cell (j, i) contributes to the left side of (108) the factor

$$-\frac{y}{D} - (j-1)D^\vee + (i-1) = -\frac{y}{D} - \frac{j-1}{D} + (i-1) = -\frac{1}{D}(y - (i-1)D + (j-1)),$$

which is $-1/D$ times the factor contributed by (i, j) to $F_{\lambda, D}(y)$; taking the product over all $|\lambda|$ cells gives (108). Applying it at $y = rD$, and noting $r^\vee D^\vee = (-rD)(1/D) = -r = -rD/D$, gives $F_{\lambda', D^\vee}(r^\vee D^\vee) = (-1/D)^{|\lambda|} F_{\lambda, D}(rD)$; applying it at $y = s$ gives $F_{\lambda', D^\vee}(-s/D) = (-1/D)^{|\lambda|} F_{\lambda, D}(s)$. By (55) the numerator of the dual pivot is $D^{-2|\lambda|}$ times that of the original, while its denominator is $(D^\vee)^{|\lambda|} H_{\lambda'}(D^\vee) = D^{-|\lambda|} H_{\lambda'}(D^\vee)$. Hence

$$\pi_{\lambda'}^{(r^\vee, D^\vee)}\left(-\frac{s}{D}\right) = \frac{H_{\lambda}(D)}{H_{\lambda'}(D^\vee)} \pi_{\lambda}^{(r, D)}(s), \quad (110)$$

and both hook products are positive by (54), so the two pivots have the same sign. Note that the dual hook is $H_{\lambda'}(D^\vee)$, evaluated at the dual parameter. Conjugation preserves $|\lambda|$ and is an involution on partitions of each size, so the correspondence is a bijection of the constraint sets at each cutoff, giving (109). Finally $-r^\vee D^\vee = rD \cdot 1/D = r$ and $4/d^\vee = d$, so the correspondence is an involution. $\square$

The involution $d \mapsto 4/d$ fixes $d = 2$, exchanges $d = 1$ with $d = 4$, and carries $d = 8$ to the formal step $1/2$. Among the multiplicities of simple Euclidean Jordan algebras of rank at least 3 it therefore permutes $\{1, 2, 4\}$ and moves the exceptional rank-3 value $d = 8$ outside the Jordan range altogether: the dual of the Albert cell is formal. The transpose duality is thus visible on the geometric axis only for $d \in \{1, 2, 4\}$.

11.2 POSITIVE-RANK LOCI DETERMINE THEIR NEGATIVE-RANK IMAGES

Transporting Corollary 10.6 through (109) supplies negative-rank loci, which the positive-rank argument does not reach directly: for $r > 0$ nonintegral with $v \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$,

$$\mathcal{W}_\infty\left(-rD, \frac{4}{d}\right) = \{-j : 0 \leq j < [r]\} \cup \left[-r - \frac{1}{D}, -[r]\right] \cup \left\{-r - \frac{\ell}{D} : 2 \leq \ell \leq v\right\}. \quad (111)$$

Formula (111) is the transport of one result only. Theorem 11.1 transports every positive-rank statement of the preceding sections: chamber positivity, the universal retained grid, the unit-numerator loci, the integral-defect classification and every finite-cutoff locus all have negative-rank images. What (111) supplies is the closed form, and that is what requires the dual pair to have integral defect. The universal grid of Proposition 9.3, by contrast, dualizes with no hypothesis on the defect: for real $\rho < 0$ and $d > 0$ with $D = d/2$,

$$\{-j : 0 \leq j \leq [-\rho D]\} \subseteq \mathcal{W}_\infty(\rho, d), \quad (112)$$

since the positive partner of (ρ, d) under Theorem 11.1 is $(-\rho D, 4/d)$, whose retained grid $\{jD^\vee\}$ maps to $\{-j\}$. A dualized cell chamber is likewise retained whenever the reciprocal step is rational. What does fail is the naive guess that the negative side is a reflection of the positive band. At

$$r = -\frac{3}{2}, \quad d = 1, \quad s = -\frac{3}{8}, \quad \lambda = (2, 2), \quad (113)$$

one finds $F_{\lambda,D}(rD) < 0$ and $F_{\lambda,D}(s) > 0$, so the pivot is strictly negative at a point a reflected band would have retained. Under Theorem 11.1 this cell is dual to $(3/4, 4)$, whose defect $1/2$ is not an integer; it therefore lies outside (111), exactly as the failure requires. No uniform closed formula is established for arbitrary negative rank. (111) treats exactly the negative cells dual to positive integral defect, and Theorem 11.1 transports the chamber, retained-grid, unit-numerator and finite-cutoff results; a general all-degree formula at negative rank is left open.

11.3 RANK ZERO ANNIHILATES EVERY NONCONSTANT MODE

The master pivot formula (55) is an algebraic identity in r , so it survives the passage to $r = 0$ even though the order-dependent apparatus of this section — the defect, the floors and ceilings, the band — does not. Exactly one clean statement is available at the wall itself.

Proposition 11.2 — Rank zero annihilates every nonconstant mode

Let $d > 0$ and $r = 0$. Every nonempty partition λ contains the cell $(1, 1)$, so $F_{\lambda,D}(0) = 0$. Hence

$$\pi_\lambda(s) = 0 \quad (\lambda \neq \emptyset) \quad (114)$$

for every real s . Thus every cutoff Gram form is positive semidefinite for every s , but its entire nonconstant sector is null; only the empty-partition mode survives.

This is the positivity-side image of the shift quotient's value $R_{0,h}(s) = 1$ from Theorem 4.2: the empty product read two ways, analytically a unit and functionally null. It is a statement about $r = 0$ alone, and it is consistent with Theorem 11.1, which fixes $r = 0$ for every d . No neighbourhood formula for $r < 0$ may be inferred from it, and none is asserted here.

12 POSITIVITY SURVIVES WHERE POLYNOMIAL CARRIERS DO NOT

The two halves of the paper answer different realizability questions, and the fractional-rank positivity computed above is where they part company. This section states what that positivity does and does not assert, and closes with the directions left open.

Remark 12.1 (Positivity does not force integrality). Fractional rank does not force loss of positivity. At rational steps whose rescaled rank lies inside a cell chamber, Theorem 8.4 gives a nontrivial positive interval; the integral-defect cases of Corollary 10.6 supply further semidefinite intervals on the lattice. A single example such as $(r, d) = (3/2, 2)$ already proves the intended claim that positivity does not force integrality. The definiteness must nevertheless be stated carefully. At $(3/2, 2)$ the open band is positive *definite*, by Theorem 10.1. At $(3/2, 4)$ definiteness depends on the cutoff: $\alpha = 1/2$ puts the cell $(3, 2)$ in the rank-null ideal, so every λ with $\lambda_3 \geq 2$ is identically null, minimally $(2, 2, 2)$. That partition first fits at $N = 6$, so for $N < 6$ the open band is positive definite, while for $N \geq 6$ it is semidefinite but not definite and becomes definite only after quotienting the ideal. Either way the fractional-rank positivity is compatible with quotient or non-polynomial realizations, but does not construct one. It therefore does not conflict with Proposition 6.1, which obstructs compatible *polynomial* Bernstein–Sato realizations rather than positive forms.

Remark 12.2 (Cap points are not classical ladder points). In the computed finite-degree loci the points 8 at $(3/2, 8)$, 6 at $(3/2, 6)$ and 12 at $(5/2, 8)$ arise as exact Pochhammer zeros: points where the critical rectangle pivot vanishes rather than changes sign. Each of the three is the cap $D[r]$, so all three are retained at every degree by Proposition 9.3, and by (80) each is the maximum of its all-degree locus. At integral defect Corollary 10.6 additionally identifies them inside the complete closed form. They are therefore fractional analogues of the discrete Wallach points, produced by a different mechanism from the classical discrete points below the band, which arise from the ladder. At $(3/2, 6)$, whose defect is not integral, the point 6 is still all-degree and isolated — the degree-six census already excludes $(5, 6)$ — although the complete locus below it remains unclassified.

Remark 12.3 (Scope). Every finite-cutoff locus above is indexed by its cutoff. The unindexed $\mathcal{W}_\infty$ is the separately defined all-degree locus, obtained by requiring nonnegativity at every cutoff. Finite-cutoff nullities must not be read as unindexed infinite-dimensional nullities. Positivity of this formal pairing is not the existence of a Euclidean Jordan algebra, a symmetric cone, or a determinant carrier. Among simple Euclidean Jordan algebras of rank at least 3, the Peirce multiplicities are $d \in \{1, 2, 4\}$, together with the exceptional value $d = 8$ only at rank 3, and rank-2 spin factors realize every integer multiplicity $d \geq 1$ [6, Ch. V]. Thus the pair $(r, d) = (3, 6)$ used here is formal, though $d = 6$ does occur for genuine rank-2 spin factors. The fractional case displayed at $d = 6$ is also the most fragile: it has no protecting ideal, and its band erodes from both ends.

Remark 12.4. The formal step $d = 6$ at integer rank 3 is a useful contrast: by Theorem 8.5 its positive locus is $\{0\} \cup \{3\} \cup [6, \infty)$ at every cutoff $N \geq 3$ — exactly the shape of a rank-3 Wallach set with $d/2 = 3$, although no Euclidean Jordan algebra has $(r, d) = (3, 6)$. Integrality of the *rank*, not realizability of the pair (r, d) , is what the positivity computation tracks.

The separation the title announces can be stated as a single result, and it is worth doing so: each clause is a specialization of a theorem already proved.

Corollary 12.1 (Analytic existence, polynomial realizability and positivity separate). Fix $d > 0$, put $D = d/2$, and let $r \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$. Then

- (i) $\mathcal{G}_D(r, \cdot)$ is meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}$;
- (ii) its spectral shift quotient admits no polynomial Bernstein–Sato datum affine-compatible with it in the sense of (28);
- (iii) the formal Jack–Riesz pairing is positive semidefinite at $s = rD$ at every cutoff.

If $rD \notin \Lambda_D$ the pairing is positive definite at $s = rD$ at every cutoff; if $rD \in \Lambda_D$ the corresponding principal rank-null ideal of Proposition 9.6 appears from its minimal rectangle degree onward, and the pairing is definite only after quotienting it.

Proof of Corollary 12.1. Part (i) is Definition 2.2. Part (ii) is Proposition 6.1, whose conclusion $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ is excluded by hypothesis. For (iii), specialize (55) at $s = rD$: the two factors coincide, so

$$\pi_\lambda(rD) = \frac{F_{\lambda,D}(rD)^2}{D^{|\lambda|} H_\lambda(D)} \geq 0$$

for every λ , since $H_\lambda(D) > 0$. This is (72). The pivot vanishes exactly when $F_{\lambda,D}(rD) = 0$, that is when λ contains a cell of content rD , which requires $rD \in \Lambda_D$; the vanishing modes are then the principal ideal of Proposition 9.6. $\square$

The continuation thus separates three notions that coincide on symmetric cones: analytic existence, polynomial realizability, and positivity. The Barnes–Gindikin symbol exists at every complex factor count. Its spectral recurrence terminates polynomially only at nonnegative integral rank. The formal Jack–Riesz pairing, however, can remain positive semidefinite at nonintegral rank. The remaining question is therefore not whether fractional rank is analytically meaningful, but whether its positive forms admit a natural nonpolynomial carrier.

Three directions remain open. The first is the effective content of Theorem 10.8: the stabilization degree and the closed form at rational nonintegral defect, where stabilization is now known to occur but no threshold is available. The second is whether finite stabilization holds at all at irrational step, where the content set is dense and the stratification argument of Theorem 10.8 has nothing to work with. The third is a complete description of the negative-rank loci, beyond the positive-rank families that Theorem 11.1 transports.

Supplementary material. A frozen archive at github.com/johnzfitch, deposited with a DOI and corresponding to a tagged Git commit, contains the exact-arithmetic verification code, the figure sources, an environment lockfile, a manifest of SHA-256 digests, and the complete finite-cutoff data. The script `verify_positivity.py` recomputes all displayed loci, erosion degrees, and tabulated finite-cutoff examples of Sections 8–11 by exact cell decomposition and exhaustive partition checks. Those scripts verify the stated computational instances; the analytic proofs and the identifications with the literature are independent of the computation.

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